

After Action Review

of UNDP's response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh

September 2017 – September 2018



*Empowered lives.
Resilient nations.*



UNDP Crisis Bureau

Acknowledgements

The Crisis Bureau would like to thank all those who contributed to this After Action Review (AAR), which was conducted by the independent consultant Moira Fratta.

We would like to express our gratitude to the staff of Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (RBAP), Bangkok Regional Hub, Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy (BERA), Bureau for Policy and Programme Support (BPPS), Bureau of Management Support (BMS), and Crisis Bureau for their insights and availability to participate in multiple rounds of individual and group discussions.

A final particular expression of appreciation to the staff of the Bangladesh Country Office for their support and participation in the AAR, recommendations on how the lessons extracted from this report could be applied in future situations.

Table of Contents

LIST OF ACRONYMS	4
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	6
1. INTRODUCTION	12
1.1 COUNTRY SITUATION AND CONTEXT	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
1.2 OBJECTIVES OF AFTER ACTION REVIEW	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
2. METHODOLOGY	12
2.1 SCOPE OF AFTER ACTION REVIEW	13
2.2 OVERVIEW OF INFORMATION NEEDED	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
2.3 DATA COLLECTION AND ANALYSIS	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
2.4 VALIDATION OF FINDINGS	34
3. ANALYSIS OF THE UNDP RESPONSE	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
3.1 CONTEXTUAL FACTORS INFLUENCING THE RESPONSE	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
3.2 TIMELINE OF CRISIS EVENTS AND RESPONSE ACTIONS	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
3.3 UNDP IN-COUNTRY STRUCTURE AND RESPONSE CAPACITY	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
4. FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
4.1 KEY FINDINGS AND LESSONS LEARNED	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
4.2 ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATIONS	34
ANNEXES	37
ANNEX 1: AFTER ACTION REVIEW TERMS OF REFERENCE	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
ANNEX 2: DESK REVIEW BIBLIOGRAPHY	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
ANNEX 3: LIST OF PEOPLE INTERVIEWED	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
ANNEX 4: SUMMARY OF INTERVIEW/SURVEY/FOCUS GROUP QUESTIONS	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.
ANNEX 5: INTERVIEW/SURVEY/FOCUS GROUP RESULTS	ERROR! BOOKMARK NOT DEFINED.

List of Acronyms

AAR	After Action Review
BAR	Before Action Review
BERA	Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy
BMS	Bureau of Management Support
BPPS	Bureau for Policy and Programme Support
CB	Crisis Board
CD	Country Director
CCA	Country Common Assessment
CMST	Crisis Management Support Team
CfW	Cash for Work
CO	Country Office
CrB	Crisis Bureau
CXB	Cox's Bazar
C2RP	Community Recovery and Resilience Project
DCD	Deputy Country Director
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
DRRF	Disaster Response and Recovery Facility
EALG	Efficient and Accountable Local Governance
ERF	Early Recovery Facility
ECHO	EU Humanitarian Aid and Civil Protection department
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
GoB	Government of Bangladesh
GPM	Governance Programme Manager
HC	Host Community
HoSO	Head of Sub-Office
HQ	Headquarters
IOM	International Organization for Migration
ISCG	Inter-Sector Coordination Group
JICA	Japan International Cooperation Agency
JRP	Joint Response Plan
RBAP	Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific
RC	Resident Coordinator
RCO	Resident Coordinator's Office
RH	Regional Hub
RM	Resource Mobilization
RRPM	Resilience and Recovery Project Manager
SEG	Strategic Executive Group
SID-CHT	Sustainable and Inclusive Development – Chittagong Hills Tract
SIDA	Swedish International Development Agency
SO	Sub-Office
SOPs	Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response
SWM	Solid Waste Management

TORs	Terms of Reference
UN	United Nations
UNDAF	United Nations Development Assistance Framework
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNHCR	United Nations High Commission for Refugees
UNW	UN Women
USD	United States Dollars
WFP	World Food Programme

Executive Summary

Introduction

Over one million Rohingya have fled violence across the border from Myanmar into Cox's Bazar and the Chittagong Hill Tracts area, with the latest massive influx starting in August 2017. This influx highly increased the stress on social and productive infrastructure and services in the region, triggering a major crisis that encompasses all social, economic and environmental aspects of life in the Cox's Bazar district, one of Bangladesh's most impoverished areas.

The Government of Bangladesh quickly responded with support from the international community, but the scale and speed of the influx has had wide-reaching consequences for the displaced population, the communities that have welcomed them and the surrounding environment.

UNDP with partners has responded to the crisis since September 2017 and it conducted an After Action Review (AAR) to identify successes, challenges and lessons learned, with the objective of strengthening corporate responses to emergencies in the future. The objective of the AAR is “to examine the performance of UNDP with respect to the response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh from September 2017 to September 2018. The AAR will highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP response to the displacement crisis, including: UNDPs corporate and country level programmatic and operational response; UN and interagency coordination; contribution to joint assessment and recovery processes.” The AAR is organized around five primary questions:

- How effective was UNDP's internal and, when and where relevant, interagency coordination?
- How timely and efficient was UNDP's management decision-making?
- How efficient and effective was the UNDP SURGE mechanism (i.e. the SURGE Planning process, the selection and deployment of UNDP staff and experts)?
- How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the crisis response (includes programme and operations elements)?
- How effective was UNDP's communications and resource mobilization?

Context and overview of events

Rohingya have been moving across the border between Bangladesh and Myanmar for decades, but the displacement triggered by violence on August 25th 2017 has been unprecedented and extremely fast. It is estimated that over 617,000 people arrived in Bangladesh, causing a very high pressure on Cox's Bazar area, its infrastructure and services. The gravity and scale of the situation pushed humanitarian agencies (and to some extent, donors) to focus exclusively on the humanitarian dimension of the crisis, at least initially; this implied that UNDP had a very limited space for advocating for the development aspects related to the crisis and the interventions needed to mitigate them.

At the beginning of the crisis UNDP was not authorized to work on the Rohingya response, and it took a while to receive Government authorization, which arrived on the 17th of October. Since then, UNDP has been involved in the Rohingya crisis response.

The Government of Bangladesh, while generously assisting Rohingya, has manifested since the beginning that it would require the displaced population to move back to Myanmar in the long term, and that it considered the current situation as a temporary solution only.

In response to the displacement, UNDP activated its Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response (SOPs); initially declared an L1 crisis in mid-September, the crisis was upgraded to Level 2 triggering broad organizational response on the 3rd October 2017. The Country Office (CO) with SURGE

support immediately deployed teams for assessments of the social, economic and environmental impact of the influx. The Crisis Bureau and BPPS released several tranches of funding to support the initial coordination, assessment and programming (USD 725,000 between September and November 2017). A SURGE Planning Team was deployed to develop a SURGE Plan with the CO. The Plan, originally for a period of 3 to 6 months, looks at the implementation of an integrated recovery framework of up to USD 25 million over an 18-month period. The CB upon request of the CO will later extend the SURGE phase to six months, and in the end it was closed after almost one year.

The CB approved the Plan in November 2017, together with the required support to CO through SURGE deployees. The first wave of deployees arrived in country in October 2017 to conduct the assessments, followed by others between December and January. In a few months, the CO developed a Strategy for the refugee influx and its impact on Cox's Bazar district and host communities. The strategy articulates UNDP's response on four areas of intervention: (1) Governance, public service delivery and rule of law; (2) Community cohesion, security and conflict prevention; (3) Inclusive recovery and development; and (4) Environmental sustainability and DRR.

For the implementation of its activities UNDP has opened a Sub-Office (SO) in Cox's Bazar; a total of fifteen SURGE positions were deployed (as several positions were extended, total deployments ascend to 22).

The CO has started multiple initiatives for this response. In January 2018, a joint mission (UNDP, UNHCR and UN Women) took place to understand the impact of the influx on host communities and governance institutions, and to look at potential for joint or coordinated support. Following the mission, the two components of the Community Recovery and Resilience (C2RP) project were funded (rule of law and conflict prevention). A livelihood initiative (cash for work) aimed at rehabilitation of community infrastructure and solid waste management was implemented with Action Aid. The solid waste management pilot became later in the year a fully-fledged project funded by SIDA.

When funding became available, more initiatives started, including community stabilization, mapping of social risks, ecosystem restoration, and disaster risk management. On the contrary, its advisory role to the Inter-Sector Coordination Group (ISCG) on disaster preparedness was well received.

Internal coordination and participation in interagency mechanisms

Internally, UNDP has been able to establish an effective coordination system, supported by the corporate coordination, and especially from RBAP, which immediately kicked-in to help the CO. At the same time, the institutionalization and division of responsibilities between the CO and the SO through an internal control framework will facilitate coordination and accountability in the future.

At interagency level, several organizations and institutions welcome UNDP's contribution to the response but many have also expressed some negative opinions on the organization, characterizing it as slow or not sufficiently participatory and sharing information. This, coupled with an initially smaller programmatic footprint, and other factors, has affected to some extent UNDP's stature in the response.

UNDP's technical advisory role on DRR is widely recognized as well as UNDP's competence and authority on the matter. So far however, UNDP has not been successful in achieving its intended results on host community support and coordination. This is due to a number of internal and external factors including extraordinary resistance from other stakeholders and their almost exclusive focus on humanitarian issues, but also an inadequate matching of staff assigned to the role with the demands of the position and a potentially insufficient support in strategic fora. Given the extraordinary constraints UNDP faced at the beginning of the crisis (not being even allowed to participate in the response from the outset), its limited capacity to table the issue of host community support should be recognized.

The increasingly evident protracted nature of the crisis offers an opportunity to UNDP to reposition itself and to contribute significantly through the finalization and dissemination of the impact assessments, as well as supporting ISCG in mapping host community support.

Leadership and decision-making

The CO took some decision that were instrumental for the success of its operations: it immediately activated an internal coordination; it initiated assessments to identify key needs and areas of operation for UNDP; it decided to channel the response through the Early Recovery Facility (ERF, now DRRF); it deployed some key staff to Cox's Bazar and it established a more permanent presence in Cox's Bazar with a SO.

Despite these positive decisions, the organizational response took some time to get traction. At the CO level, the initial response was affected by challenges faced by the CO management due to a combination of unavoidable temporary absences, limited crisis management experience and capacity within the team. By discussing options for deployment of UNDP First Responders with the CO, the Crisis Board should have recommended a crisis response advisor to be deployed to support CO management decision making in the early phase of crisis response.

The activation of the corporate support took some time initially but then rolled out quickly once initiated; corporate support was considered overall rapid and effective; the Crisis Bureau and the Regional Bureau could have advised more strongly the need to supplement the CO capacity to manage the crisis response as part of the strategic guidance and support provided to the CO.

A possible solution to detect early these kinds of challenges is an "accountability framework" that clarifies roles and responsibilities of all parties involved, as well as benchmarks for monitoring progress, indicative timelines and milestones to be reached. This could be added to the SURGE plan, providing indications on what is expected from all sides (CO, RB, Crisis Bureau).

SURGE mechanism

Overall, the SURGE support provided to the CO is evaluated as positive, with some exceptions. At least four of the 22 deployments have been evaluated as not fully successful. Most problematic were two deployments where the skills of the deployees did not fully match the requirement of an admittedly very difficult situation. Technical specialists deployed from stand-by partners have been considered very good and a welcome resource by people interviewed. Deploying assessment specialists at the beginning was a smart choice, although none of the assessments for various reasons has been as effective as it was initially hoped.

Timing, sequencing and length of deployments could be improved; deployments should have started earlier to ensure larger presence of UNDP on the ground and a faster start of the response; however, it is recognized that the period (end of the year) was not favourable.

Also, more precise guidance for deployees, particularly on terms of reference and expected deliverables, is recommended to allow them to perform at the best of their capacity.

The system for evaluations of SURGE deployees could be revised to be more transparent and inclusive; currently some skills are not easily evaluated (particularly soft skills) and there are differences in evaluation among surge deployees, depending on their contractual modality.

Programmes and operations

The design of a strategic document and accompanying concept notes is a good practice that has helped UNDP giving cohesiveness and coherence to its activities. Building upon existing project or leveraging existing expertise has also been a strategic move, although some consider that it was not done sufficiently, particularly in the area of governance and support to local administration, and that the SID-CHT project could be leveraged more extensively to strengthen Cox's Bazar response.

Among the successes of the response, stakeholders have identified niche areas of UNDP's involvement: solid waste management, DRM and providing conflict sensitive analysis. The establishment of the SO in Cox's Bazar has been instrumental for the implementation of activities and to ensure UNDP's presence on the ground. Given the type of early recovery and recovery programme activities to be implemented, the programmatic response picked up in the last quarter of 2018. The initial assessments despite being a good idea and a good practice, for various reasons could not be leveraged completely and were mostly used for internal programming (except the environment one, widely appreciated, while the social risks was informally shared with donors).

On the operational side, the establishment of a fully functional SO in Cox's Bazar was a success; informants have reported initial challenges in contracts and procurement.

Resource mobilization and communications

The investment of time and effort in developing a cohesive Strategy Note as a chapeau document indicating UNDP's areas of intervention, the development of 26 Concept Notes, and the use of these as RM tools paid off in terms of total funding. Within the period under review, the CO has mobilized USD 10.4 millions – later expanded to almost 18 millions at the time of writing. Resource mobilization however picked up towards the end of the first year of the response, which some consider late as reducing UNDP's ability to deliver significant results for several months, in the context of a massive crisis like the Rohingya one. Others consider that being UNDP mostly focused on recovery, it would have not been possible to mobilize funds much earlier.

A more strategic and more effective use of the seed funding provided by the Crisis Bureau and the Funding Window for the Emergency Development Response to Crisis and Recovery would have been necessary to convert this initial funding into sizeable and rapid resources for the CO.

The development of a communication strategy specifically for the Rohingya Crisis is a positive practice, however the strategy should be closely linked to a RM strategy and its implementation sharper in ensuring adequate communication of UNDP's activities, achievements and even challenges to relevant audiences.

Conclusions and recommendations

Conclusions

The overall assessment of UNDP's response to the Rohingya refugee crisis is mixed. Some aspects were (and are) successful; others could have been managed better.

All parties expressed overall positive feedback on internal coordination within the CO and between the CO, regional and global bureaus, with regular exchange of information, strategic advice and the necessary follow up when required. The Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (RBAP) was strongly involved since the beginning of the response, provided support on multiple fronts. Now that the SURGE phase has concluded, the CO still faces what has become a protracted crisis, which might require in the future more (or different) support.

Interagency coordination has been significantly more problematic. The unique structure of interagency coordination in Bangladesh has certainly influenced UNDP's space; however there have been significant difficulties not only linked to the resistance found, but also to UNDP's own management of the host community coordination issue. In fact, UNDP has not been successful so far in achieving its desired role on host community coordination. On the other side, UNDP's role in Disaster Risk Reduction has been easily acknowledged within the humanitarian community.

Leadership of the response has been positive, but with some challenges at CO level. A combination of factors including unavoidable temporary absences and limited emergency experience at management level, coupled with extraordinary difficulties within the context that would have required a firmer leadership, and the failure to detect early on that additional strategic support was required, have reduced the speed and scale of the response, and to some extent its effectiveness.

Overall, the SURGE support provided to the CO is evaluated as positive, with the deployment of 22 experts it has increased the CO capacity to address the crisis. Out of 22 deployments four of them have been evaluated as not fully successful and in some instances caused delays and turnover in key positions that should be avoided.

The programmatic response is well designed and articulated, but the implementation started late. UNDP is providing interesting contributions to the response (for example the conflict analysis), but implementation should be accelerated to solidly position the organization as a credible partner for recovery.

Finally, resource mobilization efforts have been quite successful but have materialized late in the year, affecting UNDP's capacity to deliver significant results in the first year of the response. The initial funding could have been used more successfully as seed funding.

Recommendations for UNDP globally

- ☑ In view of the protracted character of the crisis and its expected duration, the CO should identify any support requirements it foresees in the next year (and for longer if relevant); RBAP and the Crisis Bureau should provide orientation on what support is available at corporate level through protracted crisis mechanisms or what could be delivered as ad hoc support.
- ☑ Crisis Bureau and RBAP to provide technical guidance on promoting the humanitarian-development nexus and how it can be operationalized within the Rohingya crisis context, on livelihoods and on restoring local government functions.
- ☑ Review SOPs to include benchmarks and indicative timelines for the key moments of crisis response (corporate support activation, CB meetings, SURGE Planning and so on).
- ☑ Develop an accountability framework with clear benchmarks between the CO, the corresponding Regional Bureau and the Crisis Bureau, on expected roles and responsibilities of each, milestones to be reached and indicative timelines. This framework should be part of the SURGE Plan
- ☑ Evaluate levels of preparedness of CO and prioritize preparedness support to those with least capacity and highest risk of crises;
- ☑ Crisis Bureau to support Bangladesh CO in reaching a minimum level of additional preparedness, given existing risk of further crises (for example if a natural disaster happens in the area where refugees are hosted, or in case of a major epidemic outbreak).
- ☑ Assess the advantages, costs and modalities of increasing regional deployments (from Regional Bureaus and Hub, but also from other CO in the region, or consultants from the region); assess the advantages and costs of developing regional SURGE rosters.
- ☑ Ensure a mandatory revision and fine-tuning of the ToRs with the supervisor on the first days of deployment; provide a remote orientation (by CB / RBAP) to deployees and an in-country orientation (by CO) at the beginning of the deployment.
- ☑ Review the evaluation / recommendation practices of SURGE deployees, developing a common evaluation system regardless of the contractual modality; encourage a "debriefing session / final discussion" between supervisee and supervisor at the end of a deployment, where feedback should be provided on the performance. The Crisis Bureau could provide guidance on how to conduct these feedback discussions, and if necessary even convene and participate in them.

- ☑ CO to review procurement procedures and identify areas for improvement; Crisis Bureau, RBAP and BMS provide to the CO / Operations team a brief training / webinar on procedures that can be used in case of emergency and where further guidance can be found (like the intranet crisis portal).

Recommendations for UNDP CO

- ☑ In view of the protracted character of the crisis and its expected duration, the CO should identify any support requirements it foresees in the next year (and for longer if relevant) in close collaboration with RBAP and the CB.
- ☑ Update the CO Internal Control Framework to include the SO, indicating the division of roles and responsibilities between CO and SO; determine appropriate level of delegation and decentralization of responsibilities to the SO, to be reflected in the ICF and other relevant documents.
- ☑ During coordination meetings/calls, increase focus on programmatic coordination and guidance on strategic decisions; strengthen linkage between programme management in Dhaka and in Cox's Bazar. Encourage CO missions to the SO.
- ☑ Clarify implications of the "RC delinking" for the CO, potential immediate impact and any strategic measures necessary to take advantage of the process and minimize challenges.
- ☑ Ensure prioritization of attendance to SEG meetings at the highest representation level possible, providing regular feedback on UNDP's contribution for the response and open discussion with other decision makers on strategic issues pertaining to UNDP's response and interagency coordination.
- ☑ Accelerate the recruitment of the "host community support" coordination position seconded to ISCG, ensuring the selected candidate has the required experience and skills to navigate the demands of the role; in addition consider temporarily covering the position with current CO staff.
- ☑ UNDP should re-evaluate how to best approach the coordination of host community support in a manner that is more acceptable to the rest of partners; UNDP should assess with UNHCR (as the co-funder) what is the best use for the HC Coordinator position and if it is still relevant to second it to ISCG; if seconded agree with ISCG what the role and responsibility would be and the support and collaboration it would receive.
- ☑ Develop a methodology for a comprehensive "host community support" mapping exercise and support ISCG in conducting it (or lead it if agreed).
- ☑ Given the mutual interest in collaboration, affinity, and range of opportunities for joint programmes, UNDP should proactively explore closer collaboration and partners with UNHCR in particular on the humanitarian-development nexus and on longer-term aspects of the response.
- ☑ Fast track the finalization and dissemination of the Impact Assessments, to inform analysis and decisions on host community needs, area based programming and as an input for the elaboration of Cox's Bazar District Development Plan.
- ☑ Ensure a mandatory revision and fine-tuning of the ToRs with the supervisor on the first days of deployment; provide a remote orientation (by CB / RBAP) to deployees and an in-country orientation (by CO) at the beginning of the deployment.
- ☑ Review the 2018-2020 strategy in light of changing context and existing projects, focusing on opportunities to build upon current programmes, on the humanitarian-development nexus and on longer-term recovery planning.
- ☑ Evaluate the opportunity to expand local governance support, and accelerate engagement on the Cox's Bazar district development planning.

- ☑ CO to review procurement procedures and identify areas for improvement; Crisis Bureau provide to the CO / Operations team a brief training / webinar on procedures that can be used in case of emergency and where further guidance can be found (like the intranet crisis portal).
- ☑ Ensure that in all relevant fora (including especially with donors and key partners), progress updates are given on key activities; Develop a bimonthly bulletin for updates on UNDP's activities for external distribution.

1. Introduction

Over one million Rohingya have fled violence across the border from Myanmar into Cox's Bazar and the Chittagong Hill Tracts area, with the latest massive influx starting in August 2017. This influx highly increased the stress on social and productive infrastructure and services in the region, triggering a major crisis that encompasses all social, economic and environmental aspects of life in the Cox's Bazar district, one of Bangladesh's most impoverished areas.

The Government of Bangladesh quickly responded with support from the international community, but the scale and speed of the influx has had wide-reaching consequences for the displaced population, the communities that have welcomed them and the surrounding environment.

UNDP with partners has responded to the crisis since September 2017 and it conducted an After Action Review (AAR) to identify successes, challenges and lessons learned, with the objective of strengthening corporate responses to emergencies in the future.

2. Objectives, scope and methodology of the AAR

Following corporate crisis response activation, UNDP conducts After Action Reviews (AARs) to learn from the experience and improve its crisis response capacities. The AAR is a “structured reflection after a crisis that helps the organization to identify strengths and weaknesses, positive and negative lessons learned, how to sustain what was done well and identify areas for improvement.”

The objective of the present AAR is “to examine the performance of UNDP with respect to the response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh from September 2017 to September 2018. The AAR will highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP response to the displacement crisis, including: UNDPs corporate and country level programmatic and operational response; UN and interagency coordination; contribution to joint assessment and recovery processes.”¹

Five primary questions have been identified that will help understand how effective UNDP's overall crisis response was. These are:

- How effective was UNDP's internal and, when and where relevant, interagency coordination?
- How timely and efficient was UNDP's management decision-making?
- How efficient and effective was the UNDP SURGE mechanism (i.e. the SURGE Planning process, the selection and deployment of UNDP staff and experts)?
- How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the crisis response (includes programme and operations elements)?

¹ Terms of Reference “After Action Review of UNDP response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh”, 2018.

- How effective was UNDP's communications and resource mobilization?

The **AAR was articulated in four phases** to respond to the questions outlined: inception, data collection, analysis and reporting. The inception phase, culminating in an Inception Report, reviewed key documents provided by the Crisis Bureau and the CO, to identify main areas of focus for the AAR and to guide the data collection phase, which included a mission to Bangladesh (Dhaka and Cox's Bazar).

The data collection phase continued the desk review of key documents, identified representative stakeholders whose views on UNDP's response were gathered either through Key Informant Interviews (KII) or email questionnaires. During the mission to Bangladesh, an AAR workshop took place involving UNDP CO and Sub-Office (SO) staff, whose results are included in the report.

All information captured was analyzed according to the five main subjects of the AAR and against criteria of relevance, efficiency, and effectiveness, to understand what worked well and what could have been done better or differently, according to the AAR methodology. The draft report, findings and recommendations were validated in a meeting hosted by the Crisis Bureau with the participation of key stakeholders. The validated report was converted in a final report for internal use accompanied by a two-pager for external audiences.

3. Context and brief overview of events

a. Context and crisis response

Rohingya have been moving across the border between Bangladesh and Myanmar for decades, but the displacement triggered by violence on August 25th, 2017 has been unprecedented and extremely fast. It is estimated that over 617,000 people arrived in Bangladesh in only a few weeks, causing a very high pressure on Cox's Bazar area, its infrastructure and services. The gravity and scale of the situation pushed humanitarian agencies (and to some extent, donors) to focus exclusively on the humanitarian dimension of the crisis, at least initially, diminishing the attention on broader impacts and on development consequences for the area affected. While the focus on life-saving interventions is understandable, it also implied that UNDP had a very limited space for advocating for the development aspects related to the crisis and the interventions needed to mitigate them.

At the beginning of the crisis UNDP was not authorized to work on the Rohingya response, and it took a while to receive Government authorization, which arrived on the 17th of October, allowing 4 agencies including UNDP to intervene in the Rohingya response in Cox's Bazar. This "late start" could not be avoided but it has certainly meant a handicap for UNDP's positioning among humanitarian actors, who were present and in force from the first days of displacement and even before attending previous crises.

The Government of Bangladesh, while generously assisting Rohingya (although not recognizing them refugee status), since the beginning has manifested that it would require the displaced population to move back to Myanmar in the long term, and that it considered the current situation as a temporary solution only. Upcoming elections at the end of 2018 have influenced GoB positions on the Rohingya crisis, and consequently the discussions on some aspects of the response. At the time of the AAR, many actors manifested that some key issues would have to await the results of the elections before being moved forward, in particular longer-term planning on the crisis and the linkages between humanitarian action and development. After elections and depending on the results, it is likely that a more open conversation will take place on the impact of the influx in the area and on longer-term planning of humanitarian and development issues.

Despite the focus of most humanitarian organizations and donors strictly on the humanitarian dimension of the crisis, it could largely be expected that such a massive influx would not be resolved quickly and this would likely become a protracted crisis. After more than one year humanitarian actors appear more open to consider this issue and to look into the long-term impact of the influx in affected areas.

b. Brief overview of the events

On 25th August 2017 the largest and most rapid influx of Rohingya into Bangladesh started, fleeing Rakhine State in Myanmar. Over 671,000 Rohingya crossed the border in a few months, and continued to flee (approximately one million are registered in Bangladesh now) causing an unprecedented humanitarian crisis and strain in Cox's Bazar region.

In response to the displacement, UNDP activated its Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response (SOPs); initially declared an L1 crisis in mid-September, the crisis was upgraded to Level 2 triggering broad organizational response on the 3rd October 2017. The CO with SURGE support immediately deployed teams for assessments of the social, economic and environmental impact of the influx, in collaboration with UN Women. The Crisis Bureau and BPPS released several tranches of funding to support the initial coordination, assessment and programming (USD 725,000 between September and November 2017).

Due to the regional dimension of the crisis, UNDP conducted joint Myanmar/Bangladesh Crisis Board (CB) Meetings, with individual CSMTs for each country. A SURGE Planning Team was deployed to Dhaka from October 30th to November 3rd, to develop a SURGE Plan with the CO. The Plan, originally for a period of 3 to 6 months, looks at the implementation of an integrated recovery framework of up to USD 25 million over an 18-month period. The CB upon request of the CO will later extend the SURGE phase to six months, and in the end it was closed after almost one year.

The CB approved the Plan in November 2017, together with the required support to CO through SURGE deployees. The first wave of deployees arrived in country in October 2017 to conduct three assessments, followed by others between December and January. Of the three assessments (social, economic and environmental), the environmental assessment has been the most positively received. On the basis of the assessments and needs identified, as well as the programmatic priorities recorded in the SURGE Plan, the CO has developed a Strategy for the refugee influx and its impact on Cox's Bazar district and host communities. The strategy articulates UNDP's response on four areas of intervention:

- Governance, public service delivery and rule of law;
- Community cohesion, security and conflict prevention
- Inclusive recovery and development
- Environmental sustainability and DRR.

For the implementation of its activities UNDP has opened a SO in Cox's Bazar (while present on the ground since October 2017, the office opened formally in February 2018); a total of fifteen SURGE positions were deployed (with some changes from the initial plan that will be discussed under the SURGE section). As several positions were extended, total deployments ascend to 22. In April, several of the 'first wave' deployees left, and a second wave started in April/May with some gaps between the two periods. SURGE deployments continued throughout the year until October/November 2018.

The CO has started multiple initiatives for this response. In January 2018, a joint mission (UNDP, UNHCR and UN Women) took place to understand the impact of the influx on host communities and governance institutions, and to look at potential for joint or coordinated support. Following the mission, the two components of the Community Recovery and Resilience (C2RP) project were funded (rule of law and conflict prevention). A livelihood initiative (cash for work) aimed at rehabilitation of community infrastructure and solid waste management was implemented with Action Aid. When funding became available, more initiatives started including community stabilization, mapping of social risks, solid waste management ecosystem restoration, and disaster risk management. UNDP also embarked in several unsuccessful attempts at coordinating interagency support to host communities.² On the contrary, its advisory role to the Inter-Sector Coordination Group (ISCG) on disaster preparedness was well received. The table in Annex VI

² See section on Interagency Coordination for more details.

shows in more detail the succession of events, key events and actions related to the crisis response within UNDP and by external actors, including Government, UN and donors.

4. Internal and interagency coordination

a. UNDP's internal coordination

Corporate coordination

The corporate mechanism for crisis response was activated relatively quickly: the first Crisis Management Support Team (CMST) coordinated by the Regional Bureau and the Crisis Bureau took place two and a half weeks after the beginning of the Rohingya influx in Bangladesh; SOPs were used extensively, from an initial classification of the crisis as Level 1 (mainly due to UNDP's limitations in accessing Cox's Bazar and the limited scope of the initial collective response) to a scale-up as Level 2 and the activation of larger corporate support.

There were no "First responders" as such but four assessment specialists were deployed in the second half of October (2 months after the beginning of the crisis). The SURGE Planning team was also deployed at the end of October. In the early stage of the crisis and taking into account the absence of the Country Director due to unavoidable reasons, the Deputy Country Director as the officer in charge would have benefitted from the deployment of experienced UNDP First Responders to support in the early phase of crisis response. The Crisis Board could have discussed this matter with the CO when scaling up to crisis Level 2.

Because of the regional dimension of the crisis, Crisis Board meetings were held jointly between Myanmar and Bangladesh, with individual CMST meetings for more operational support. The organization provided significant financial contributions to the CO in the first stages (repeated TRAC 113 emergency allocations and programme funding), plus a total of USD 796,000 in SURGE deployments for the 15 fully funded SURGE positions deployed.

The Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (RBAP) was strongly involved since the beginning of the response, provided support on multiple fronts including participation in the SURGE planning team, providing technical support on programmatic matters with multiple missions, convening high-level meetings to facilitate solutions pertaining to the overall coordination of the response, financially contributing to the Head of Sub-Office (HOSO) position, and facilitating the fast release for a SURGE deployee from another country office in the region.

All parties expressed positive feedback on internal coordination between the CO, regional and global bureaus, with regular exchange of information, strategic advice and the necessary follow-up when required. In general, coordination and support were provided whenever required and were of good quality; the involvement of the Bureau of External Relations and Advocacy (BERA) has been qualified by respondents as more sporadic.

The SURGE phase has now concluded, but the CO still faces a protracted crisis. The SOPs apply in protracted crises only in case of significant changes, but support might be necessary aside of SOPs and SURGE activation. In fact, in view of the challenges identified in this AAR and with the experienced gained in the last year, the CO is advised to identify strategic and programmatic support it might require for the next months.³

³ In fact, ad hoc support is already provided: the Crisis Bureau is also funding 50% of the cost of the HoSO and the UN Coordinator Specialist (respectively P5 and P4); These amount to USD 139,716 and USD 122, 526 (proforma costs).

R: In view of the protracted character of the crisis and its expected duration, the CO should identify any support requirements it foresees in the next year (and for longer if relevant); RBAP and the Crisis Bureau should provide orientation on what support is available at corporate level through protracted crisis mechanisms or what could be delivered as ad hoc support.

CO coordination

The CO mobilized at the outset of the crisis. It activated in September a Working Group for internal coordination on the Rohingya crisis and to support the SURGE planning mission.

Within the CO management, the Deputy Country Director (DCD) was entrusted to lead the internal coordination through some effective internal coordination mechanisms: the weekly update from the Cox's Bazar Sub-Office (SO) is accompanied the following day by a weekly call chaired by the DCD to discuss key issues emerging and to address the needs of the SO. Focal points were identified for all topics and projects (although some reportedly have been less successful than others). All parties interviewed have expressed very good collaboration and willingness to work together to solve issues arising. Some responders have observed that more coordination between CO and SO and more support from Programmes would be useful on long-term and strategic decisions – the C2RP project in particular was mentioned.

R: During coordination meetings/calls, increase focus on programmatic coordination and guidance on strategic decisions; strengthen linkage between programme management in Dhaka and in Cox's Bazar. Encourage CO missions to the SO.

Until now there has not been an institutionalization of the division of roles and responsibilities through an “Internal control framework.”⁴ It is reasonable that such a framework would not be immediately available at the opening of a SO and in the middle of an emergency; one year later it is time to develop it, especially considering that the SO will likely exist for some time. The elaboration of the framework is an opportunity to revise the level of delegation of authority to the SO, including taking advantage of the different positions based in the SO now⁵; some respondents have encouraged an increase in delegation to facilitate activities, reduce the need for consultation on small decisions, and empower the SO, including on operational matters.

R: Update the CO Internal Control Framework to include the SO, indicating the division of roles and responsibilities between CO and SO; determine appropriate level of delegation and decentralization of responsibilities to the SO, to be reflected in the ICF and other relevant documents.

The “delinking” of the Resident Coordinator (RC) from UNDP⁶ did not particularly influence the period under review in the AAR, but it merits some attention moving forward. The CO should analyze what possible challenges (or advantages) could derive from the new arrangement and prepare to address them as needed, in coordination with the RC as pertinent.

R: Clarify implications of the “RC delinking” for the CO, potential immediate impact and any strategic measures necessary to take advantage of the process and minimize challenges.

b. Participation in interagency coordination mechanisms

⁴ The CO has an ICF but the Sub-Office is not included.

⁵ IC holders – the contractual status of the majority of people deployed to the SO initially – cannot be delegated authorities according to UNDP rules.

⁶ Effective from January 1st, 2019.

UNDP initial engagement in the response and external perceptions

Several organizations and institutions welcome UNDP's contribution to the response, although its footprint is small compared to others;⁷ they see it as complementary to their efforts and recognize its added value in specific areas, like solid waste management, disaster risk reduction, the support to local governance to name a few.

Unfortunately, UNDP was not authorized to participate in the Rohingya response until mid-October 2017, when the Government authorized 4 additional UN agencies to operate in Cox's Bazar. This was a significant handicap that has contributed to some negative perceptions of the agency.

The vast majority of external informants (donors, other agencies, coordination bodies) have characterized UNDP as slow or very slow (in establishing presence, finalizing assessments, initiating project implementation and so on); reportedly, even some local authorities would have complained about UNDP's slowness. While the initial delay was not UNDP's responsibility, it has not been compensated by a fast engagement afterwards, and the perception of slowness was cemented.

Some agencies and some donors have conveyed that people have strong (negative) opinions on UNDP for multiple reasons: a perceived lack of capacity, difficult or unsuccessful deployments in the past, not being engaged in the response from the beginning and currently having limited programmes in Cox's Bazar, but wanting to take leadership roles "stepping on others' toes."⁸ There is very strong institutional competition, especially in Dhaka; UNDP is traditionally not viewed as a humanitarian actor⁹ and therefore its involvement in the response was questioned (as it happens frequently in other crises around the world); now that actors are starting to consider medium-term interventions and the long term impact of the refugee influx, acceptance has vastly improved.

External partners (including donors, agencies, coordination bodies) have also conveyed that UNDP at country level has been considered as an 'individualistic' agency not very prone to consultation and communication. These perceptions are known to the CO (and to some extent they might still possibly be valid) and efforts are being made to be more participatory –the strategic note include collaboration with others as one of its six principles of work. UNDP should continue to make supplementary efforts to be inclusive and gain (back) the trust of other stakeholders, especially when intervening in a 'new' context like a humanitarian crisis in which it is already perceived as an outsider. For example, the initial assessments could have involved other organizations in addition to UN Women. The current impact assessments led by UNDP and conducted with a number of other agencies, offer the opportunity to show inclusiveness and collaboration.

Some respondents – particularly external partners - have expressed the opinion that UNDP has been weak in assuming its role; as an example, a perception from an external partner was expressed as follows "it is not clear to [the partner] what UNDP considers to be its own role in the response."¹⁰ In the view of some, UNDP has not engaged sufficiently on governance, despite repeated requests for support from authorities and it has not provided sufficient support to the Deputy Commissioner's Office, including technical support on the

⁷ UNDP's total financial engagement amounts to almost USD 10.4 millions (until September 2018, the period covered by this AAR) within a global funded response of approximately USD 370 million at the end of September 2018, out of a total appeal of 950 million. These figures have substantively increased by December 2018: UNDP's total funding is over 17.5 millions, while the JRP funding recorded on FTS is approximately 650 millions.

⁸ Stakeholder interview.

⁹ One of the persons interviewed poetically referred to the "humanitarian temptation of development actors" to indicate the interest of development organizations for humanitarian crisis primarily because of funding.

¹⁰ Stakeholder interview.

District Development Plan (which is already in UNDP's plans once the impact assessments are finalized). According to CO informants, the elections planned for December 2018 have postponed GoB's engagement on the District Development Plan, which will be discussed in February 2019; and UNDP will assist GoB when it is ready on this matter.

Other informants suggest that UNDP should have a more proactive role in bringing the development point of view in the response; on this regard, it should be noted that the GoB since the beginning has considered the Rohingya response as a temporary solution until their return to Myanmar, while at the same time emphasizing the impact on the area and the local communities (this is mentioned at the CB meeting on November 17th, 2017).

Now that the CO is receiving more funding and it is beginning to implement new projects, there is a very good opportunity to re-position the organization and change some of these negative perceptions. The crisis has become a protracted one and the context is now more conducive to UNDP's participation. UNDP should focus on rapidity, high-quality project implementation and high-quality analysis, interventions on governance and development widely accepted as its own mandate, and leverage alliances within the humanitarian and development community and donors' community.

Interagency coordination

The interagency coordination in Bangladesh has a unique and complex structure:¹¹ UNHCR and IOM jointly coordinate the response (despite being in principle a refugee crisis) together with the RC through the Strategic Executive Group (SEG). Operational coordination takes place in Cox's Bazar through the Inter-sectorial Coordination Group (ISCG). The ISCG is staffed mostly by UNHCR and IOM, and led by a Senior Coordinator who reports to the three co-chairs of the SEG (Resident Coordinator, IOM and UNHCR). UNDP attends both SEG and to ISCG meetings.

The dynamics and tensions between UNHCR and IOM have strongly influenced the response; a recent lesson learned exercise concluded that the existing coordination structure does not ensure proper accountability and that some coordination structures have become cumbersome. The SEG agreed on a review of the coordination architecture, in which UNDP participates (despite initial opposition) together with IOM and UNHCR; the results of the review are still pending at the time of writing. Some perceive UNDP as 'aligned' to UNHCR, which is not negative *per se* – and it should be expected given the global partnership between the two organizations - but can become relevant in such a polarized coordination environment characterized by tensions between IOM and UNHCR for the coordination of the response.

It is clear that UNDP's consistent participation in the SEG is important to ensure a strong, consistent institutional voice. As the SEG is the most strategic forum for critical decision-making on the Rohingya response, and given the resistance UNDP has faced so far on some issues, it is advisable that the Country Director represents UNDP.

Some informants have highlighted that a more assertive voice from UNDP in the SEG would be recommendable; the CO however indicates that the SEG meetings are focused on macro and political issues and the SEG is not the most indicated forum for interagency positioning. A review of the SEG minutes suggests that UNDP could make its voice heard more, and matters that directly affect its work – like host community support coordination – could be supported more strongly. Of the 21 meetings analyzed for this review,¹² UNDP is recorded as intervening in 6 cases.¹³ For example, when the Host Community

¹¹ Annex VII shows the Rohingya response coordination structure.

¹² Minutes between November 2017 and September 2018.

Working Group ToRs (agreed in December) were again called into question in February, SEG minutes only record JICA supporting the need for a structured coordination on host community.

R: Ensure prioritization of attendance to SEG meetings at the highest representation level possible, providing regular feedback on UNDP's contribution for the response and open discussion with other decision-makers on strategic issues pertaining to UNDP's response and interagency coordination.

UNDP's advisory role to the ISCG in Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) has been easily acknowledged within the humanitarian community. A number of factors have contributed: UNDP's expertise and long institutional and programmatic commitment on DRR in the country, which gave it credibility; the early recognition by all actors of DRR as a priority; the clarity of the mandate: UNDP provides technical advice on preparedness to the Emergency Task Force and the ISCG per their request; the continuity of staff deployed from CO and the recognized in-country experience and technical capacity of staff working on DRR issues, acknowledged by all including by authorities; and the choice of an advisory role rather than a coordinating one, coupled with some funding to implement activities (although admittedly not major funding yet). Another factor in the DRR work being accepted is that UNDP focused initially on providing localized, technical advice and support to GoB dialogue with the humanitarian actors in a very specific niche, listening to a variety of stakeholders and being consistently present.

The experience in Bangladesh on DRR could be considered for replication/adaptation in similar circumstances:

1. Identify a specific niche area where the CO has existing expertise and UNDP has a clear mandate (for example support to governance functions, DRR, solid waste management, others)
2. Focus initial engagement on sustained technical support to Government and humanitarian actors in engaging with the niche topic in the specific context; including mapping of existing investments, capacity and gaps; conducting or facilitating technical assessments; identification and sustained engagement with the appropriate humanitarian fora (at strategic and at technical and sectorial levels); for this, a combination of CO and SURGE deployments over 6 months minimum is critical;
3. Complement technical support with strategic technically-focused SURGE-funded activities (placement of IM, technical and liaison officers with government, installation of specialized equipment, piloting specialized activities, starting systematic, longitudinal Communication with Communities feedback collection to inform nexus programming)
4. Engage donors and other agencies in technical/strategic nexus discussions; then on the basis of these activities engage in resource mobilization.

The experience on DRR is in stark contrast with UNDP's role and achievements in Host Community (HC) support and coordination, much less successful. UNDP first raised the issue of host community needs at the time of the Early Recovery Initial Assessment, highlighting the necessity of a coordinated approach. This opinion was shared by the GoB that indicated from the beginning the need to support local populations. UNDP must also be credited with having brought the issue to the attention of humanitarian agencies, so that host community support is featured in the Joint Response Plan (JRP). A common definition and approach to "host community" has been lacking,¹⁴ and different actors look at different groups from diverse perspectives, frequently privileging a protection approach.¹⁵ Others believe

¹³ The SEG minutes are not taken *verbatim*, therefore some of UNDP's interventions are likely recorded without attribution. As a comparison, UNHCR is on record 18 times, IOM 12 times and WFP 9 times (out of the same 21 meetings).

¹⁴ For example, some informants stress that the geographical scope of the JRP is limited to the two most impacted upazilas in Cox's Bazar, therefore only the host population within this area could

that the host community needs should be addressed in their own right, from a development perspective and not as a function of protecting refugees. The lack of agreement on the concept itself and on the approach have contributed to the difficulty of finding a common ground on host community support.

A Host Community Working Group was established under the ISCG, led by UNDP despite strong resistance within the ISCG itself and from other agencies. The opposition from traditional humanitarian agencies and the strong focus in the first months on purely humanitarian response could be likely ascribed to underfunding, earmarking of funds exclusively for refugee response, and the risk of further competition for scarce resources (the JRP was severely underfunded for several months). ToRs were discussed in December but in February of the following year the ISCG was still discussing the relevance of a HCWG. In the end the HCWG did not last due to several factors:

- “1) an unclear definition of the concept of host communities (within or beyond the two directly affected Upazilas);
- 2) objections from other sectors as to its relevance at the time of the crisis;
- 3) lack of clarity on why it was a ‘stand-alone’ forum and not mainstreamed into the sectors; and
- 4) lack of sustained and appropriate capacity from UNDP to chair it.”¹⁶

In addition, UNDP did not have a large programme footprint at the time. Other agencies had larger programmes and were also working on host community support; therefore UNDP’s role as coordinator was not automatically accepted.

The personnel that UNDP seconded to the ISCG as “Host Community Coordinators / Advisors”¹⁷ were not always considered the most appropriate match to the requirements of the position.¹⁸ The HC Coordinators have been seen as not always neutral (but favoring UNDP); respondents indicated severe personality clashes with ISCG and with other agencies; after the last HCC left in June 2018 the position has been vacant for several months, which does not reflect well on UNDP’s ability to fulfil the role. Such a key position should not have remained uncovered for 5 months. While recognizing the multiple difficulties in encountering an available candidate with the adequate skills,¹⁹ UNDP and UNHCR should now accelerate recruitment and in the meanwhile ensure presence in the ISCG as quickly as possible.

R: Accelerate the recruitment of the “host community support” coordination position seconded to ISCG, ensuring the selected candidate has the required experience and skills to navigate the demands of the role; in addition consider temporarily covering the position with current CO staff.

be considered, while others consider the impact more broadly on the entire District. Also “host community” has at various times meant the local population physically the camps; the local population hosting Rohingya families; the local population in the immediate vicinity of the camps, and so on.

¹⁵ Host community support is done to ensure social cohesion and prevent conflict by addressing the needs of the host population, which otherwise feels excluded.

¹⁶ Rheka Das Back to Office Report, September 2018.

¹⁷ This position is the same as the UN Coordinator in the SURGE Plan, but it is often referred to with different denominations. Currently UNDP and UNHCR have agreed to cover jointly the position for one year.

¹⁸ While internal stakeholders recognize the skills and commitment of these personnel and the difficulties they faced, external stakeholders have mostly focused on the negative and most visible aspects of the situation, the tensions among people and the difficulty to work together.

¹⁹ Two successive rounds of recruitment have failed when the selected candidate has declined the position. UNHCR was supposed to recruit the position after UNDP SURGE deployment ended; after a long wait, the candidate who was selected declined the offer. Then UNHCR asked UNDP to recruit, but by then the candidate that UNDP identified was no longer available due to the long wait. Later the recruitment was deliberately not accelerated to wait for the outcomes of the review mission for the coordination structure, as it was not clear how this might impact the position. In December 2018 the recruitment is back on track and the interview is expected to take place before the end of the year.

UNDP's rightful attention to the development dimension of the crisis faced a very strong resistance from some agencies and within the coordination system; perhaps after a certain number of unsuccessful attempts to advocate for host community support, a different approach could have been tried earlier; for example engaging sooner with the District on strengthening the District Development Plan (something that seemed more acceptable to some external stakeholders than host community support) – this is currently in UNDP's plans after the finalization of the impact assessments.

The experience of the Bangladesh CO in this situation could also be useful for broader reflection by UNDP globally on the opportunity and best strategies to app community coordination, UNDP could consider supporting local governments in coordinating their host community support and by extension coordinating other agencies and partners. A brief review of other experiences and other COs solutions could help shed more light on the idea suggested and its viability.

Some respondents have now indicated that the debate has moved from “host communities” (described as a divisive term and a divisive approach) to “social cohesion”, and that organizations should look into area-based approach programming. This is an opportunity for UNDP to refocus its advocacy to a more accepted terminology, while continuing to advocate for the right to development of all populations involved in the current crisis.

There seems to be a more conducive environment for the success of the host community coordination role now, but difficulties remain. Several agencies have expanded their HC support and are starting to develop a longer-term vision on the response; a recent report indicates that some agencies believe UNDP and UNHCR should convene the HC coordination in ISCG; but others believe that there should not be a separate coordination mechanism and it should be integrated into existing ones (for example the Livelihoods Working Group or the Energy and Environment Working Group).

R: UNDP should re-evaluate how to best approach the coordination of host community support in a manner that is more acceptable to the rest of partners; UNDP should assess with UNHCR (as the co-funder) what is the best use for the HC Coordinator position and if it is still relevant to second it to ISCG; if seconded agree with ISCG what the role and responsibility would be and the support and collaboration it would receive.

One of the functions of this position could be to lead a comprehensive mapping of GoB and development partners' investments in Cox's Bazar prior to the influx and afterwards; this was discussed in January 2018 at the SEG and the task assigned to ISCG in the “medium term”; several stakeholders believe such a mapping could be facilitated by UNDP within the ISCG framework. There is some partial mapping ongoing but information on it is confused: stakeholders report that such mapping has been discussed frequently but there are no results available yet as well as lack of information on the reasons of the delay. One of UNDP's SURGE deployees is helping ISCG / Information Management group on a mapping but it appears the results are not comprehensive yet.

R: Develop a methodology for a comprehensive “host community support” mapping exercise and support ISCG in conducting it (or lead it if agreed).

Host community needs will be identified through the “Impact assessment of the Rohingya Influx in Cox's Bazar and Banderban Districts” currently under finalization. The assessments were launched in May 2018 and a prestigious partner (the Policy Research Institute of Bangladesh – PRI) was selected as technical counterpart. They include 5 areas:

- The economic, employment, livelihoods and socio-economic impact (led by UNDP, ILO, and UNHCR)
- The infrastructure (UNOPS)
- The capacity to meet increased public service demand (UNDP)
- The pressure on space and spatial planning (UNHABITAT)
- Challenges in delivering social safety net programmes (UNDP)

These assessments are a very positive initiative, as they fill a significant gap in the knowledge around the crisis, and will be instrumental to inform humanitarian-development nexus initiatives and medium to long-term programming.

The expansion of the assessments' scope as well as technical issues related to the quality of the results are delaying their finalization and publication of the assessments; some stakeholders have highlighted the lack of clear information about the progress of these assessments; limited communication and consultations has been reported on multiple occasions by a variety of informants. UNDP should carefully avoid a situation similar to that of the initial assessments, in which an important investment was partially ineffective due to delays in sharing results and quality of the products, to some extent hurting UNDP's perception as a reliable partner. On the contrary, the assessments represent an opportunity to engage with high-quality information and analysis with the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank who are heavily investing in the crisis response.

R: Given the importance of the Impact Assessment, CO management should closely follow the fast-tracking of their finalization and dissemination, to inform analysis and decisions on host community needs, area based programming and as an input for the elaboration of Cox's Bazar District Development Plan.

Some respondents have suggested that UNDP could have engaged better with the World Bank on its funding of the crisis response, also considering that a lot of the funding will benefit host communities and UNDP would be a natural counterpart on this. The GoB will implement the World Bank funding (at least the part released so far). A handover note from March 2018 indicates as one of the follow-up actions to discuss with the World Bank the results of the impact assessment once available, in view of identifying areas for a potential partnership arrangement.

Finally, a key interagency gap that UNDP could fulfill (and is already considering) is providing technical support on the humanitarian – development nexus. At the time of writing there was a stark absence of joint analysis of the intertwined humanitarian and development dimensions of the crisis; which is the more surprising as a crisis of this magnitude could be easily identified from the beginning as likely to become protracted. The joint analysis should precede joint planning that combines humanitarian and development nexus and beyond into medium to long term development planning. In 2019 development partners are due to revise the Country Common Analysis (CCA) and subsequently elaborate the UN Development Assistance Framework (UNDAF) in 2021. However, there is not much clarity yet among agencies on what “the nexus” entails, if it is related to transitioning the response to a more sustainable model, if it relates to the linkages between the refugee response and support to overall development, or if it is something entirely different. Given its focus on development, UNDP could decide to strategically engage on “nexus” and joint planning. This is also coherent with the World Humanitarian Summit commitments and the “New Way of Working” towards collective outcomes. Globally there is no guidance yet on how to operationalize the visionary agreements of the WHS; the current situation in Bangladesh is an excellent opportunity to develop a collective vision and pioneering ‘nexus (and beyond)’ joint planning and programming. In fact, a recent UNDP mission recommended the deployment of a Strategic Advisor on Humanitarian-Development Nexus to the RCO. Stakeholders within the CO have indicated that more guidance on how to approach the humanitarian-development nexus and how to promote it within the Rohingya crisis context would be welcome; also that more support would have been useful on livelihoods programming and on how to restore local governance functions.

R: Crisis Bureau and RBAP to provide technical guidance on promoting the humanitarian-development nexus and how it can be operationalized within the Rohingya crisis context, on livelihoods and on restoring local government functions.

Coordination with Individual agencies

UNDP strong reengagement with UNHCR globally since 2017 has facilitated collaboration at country level.

UNHCR has expressed willingness and interest in closer partnership with UNDP in the response. There are opportunities for collaboration in social cohesion, rule of law, and governance, as highlighted by the joint UNDP-UNHCR-UNW mission of January 2018, which was regarded as a very positive experience and a recommended practice by the three agencies. Some respondents have observed the limited engagement of the CO during the mission, which comprised mainly of HQ based staff from UNDP, UNW and UNHCR, and of SURGE staff from the CO. The team therefore did not have local expertise, and it was felt that the follow-up to the mission could have been stronger. The analysis conducted on the occasion identified several entry points for joint programming, however this has not been fully materialized yet as UNDP and UNHCR have mostly developed programmes on their own, despite the expressed interest and willingness to collaborate. The two agencies are working together on the solid waste management project and on disaster risk management, and have agreed to co-share the cost of the HC coordinator position in ISCG. UNDP and UN Women instead have jointly designed a programme on support to community stabilization and resilience, funded by Germany. UNDP and UNHCR have further planned to collaborate into how to address the humanitarian-development nexus during a UNDP-UNHCR brainstorming workshop in Dhaka planned for September 2018; unfortunately the workshop had to be canceled on UNHCR side and it was held only internally. At the time of writing UNHCR had recently hired a Development Officer and was planning to hire a Nexus Advisor; these can be engaged to explore further collaboration on programmes.

R: Given the mutual interest in collaboration, affinity, and range of opportunities for joint programmes, UNDP should proactively explore closer collaboration and partners with UNHCR in particular on the humanitarian-development nexus and on longer-term aspects of the response.

Coordination with other agencies (for example IOM in the ECHO-funded project) and with agencies resolutely opposing UNDP's initiatives on host community coordination has been more difficult.

5. Leadership and decision-making

a. CO level

The CO made some decisions that were instrumental for the success of its operations: it immediately activated an internal coordination; it initiated assessments to identify key needs and areas of operation for UNDP; it decided to channel the response through the Early Recovery Facility (ERF, now DRRF); it deployed some key staff to Cox's Bazar and it established a more permanent presence in Cox's Bazar with a SO.

Despite these positive decisions, the organizational response took some time to get traction. At the CO level, the response was affected by challenges faced by the CO management due to a combination of unavoidable temporary absences and limited crisis management experience as well as capacity within the team.

In the words of one respondent 'the success of UNDP's crisis response needs the CO management at the center and in the lead'.²⁰ One senior stakeholder has reflected that perhaps "the deployment of a second in command in the office to oversee UNDP's operations related to the refugee crisis could have helped ensure

²⁰ Stakeholder interview.

a stronger response.”²¹ By discussing options for deployment of UNDP First Responders with the CO, the Crisis Board should have recommended a crisis response advisor to be deployed to support CO management decision-making in the early phase of crisis response.

Several informants have observed that a senior, emergency-experienced UNDP manager could have been assigned to support the CO Management; others have pointed out the need for a coordinator in Dhaka for SURGE staff; the original SURGE plan foresees Programme Advisors based in Dhaka; these various options all point into one direction: a senior figure based in Dhaka and acting as a bridge between the CO and the SO (as well as between the CO and the SURGE deployees), to support existing management with the additional workload derived from the crisis response. These observations would also need to be seen in light of whether the ToRs of the two programme advisors deployed initially to be based in Dhaka could have been better aligned to support the CO management capacity to coordinate the crisis response. It should be noted that one of the programme advisors was however deployed to Cox’s Bazar and did not remain in Dhaka.

The CO recognizes that was not fully prepared to manage a crisis of this scale; it did not have sufficient internal capacity and expertise and had a limited knowledge of SOPs and emergency response facilities available within the organization; it had limited preparedness measures taken and it found it on occasions difficult to switch gears from a development *modus operandi* to an emergency one.

UNDP globally should ensure that all its senior managers are trained on emergency management, SOPs, SURGE system, and that a minimum level of readiness is guaranteed in each CO. Should this not be done yet at the time a crisis happens, it is advisable either to offer coaching/training on the spot to the managers in place, or depending on the situation and if deemed necessary, to deploy temporarily an experienced senior manager that can support CO management in the crisis, particularly at the very beginning when UNDP engagement and rapidity of action are paramount for a solid positioning of the organization.

There is a risk that during the next monsoon seasons Cox’s Bazar area could be affected; given the vulnerability of Rohingya in the existing conditions, it is possible that a further crisis happens on top of the current one, for which the humanitarian community is admittedly not ready. UNDP has therefore the responsibility to prepare internally – and to the extent possible to contribute to interagency preparedness. It is expected that the fully functioning UNDP Sub-Office, which has been established as part of the UNDP response to Rohingya crisis in Cox’s Bazar, will facilitate relevant and timely response to this potential crisis, with the support of the CO as needed.

R: Evaluate levels of preparedness of CO and prioritize preparedness support to those with least capacity and highest risk of crises.

R: Crisis Bureau to support Bangladesh CO in reaching a minimum level of additional preparedness, given existing risk of further crises (for example if a natural disaster happens in the area where refugees are hosted, or in case of a major epidemic outbreak).

b. Corporate level

The activation of the corporate support took some time initially but then rolled out quickly once initiated.

The displacement started on 25th August and the first CB meeting (when the crisis was declared L1) takes place on the 14th September. By September 13th, ISCG had already reported 390,000 new arrivals in Bangladesh since August 25th, almost 20,000 people per day. From an emergency point of view having the first Crisis Board meeting 3 weeks after the beginning of the displacement is not considered rapid. At the

²¹ Stakeholder interview.

same time, it is to be noted that UNDP corporate response was initiated proactively despite the context that UNDP did not have a role in responding to the Rohingya crisis in Cox's Bazar until October 2017.

R: Review SOPs to include benchmarks and indicative timelines for the key moments of crisis response (corporate support activation, key CB meetings, SURGE Planning and so on).

Two weeks the first CB, the crisis level was rightly escalated from L1 to L2, proactively triggering corporate support even if UNDP still not had the authorization to operate in Cox's Bazar (which would arrive in mid-October); this would be instrumental in ensuring a rapid deployment of the SURGE Planning team and the approval of the SURGE Plan.

Given the regional character of the crisis, CB meetings were held jointly. The Crisis Board also approved multiple allocations of funds to support the initial coordination and assessments. The Regional Bureau on its part was strongly engaged at the highest level, convening strategic meetings when required to foster collaboration among agencies in the response.

The corporate support was overall rapid and effective; the Crisis Bureau and the Regional Bureau could have advised more strongly the need to supplement the CO capacity to manage the crisis response as part of the strategic guidance and support provided to the CO. The CO might not have been fully aware of needing more support: an office in the middle of a crisis is often too busy and too in-depth into response activities and local dynamics to realize its own difficulties and it is the responsibility of the rest of the organization to step in. In fact, the recently finalized new SOPs foresee such a need: in all L2 crises they recommend an assessment of the CO management team coordination and management capacities at the beginning of an L2 activation; this could be done in other moments as well, if necessary.

A possible solution to detect early these kinds of challenges is an “accountability framework” that clarifies roles and responsibilities of all parties involved, as well as benchmarks for monitoring progress, indicative timelines and milestones to be reached. This could be added to the SURGE plan, providing indications on what is expected from all sides (CO, RB, Crisis Bureau).

R: Develop an accountability framework with clear benchmarks between the CO, the corresponding Regional Bureau and the Crisis Bureau, on expected roles and responsibilities of each, milestones to be reached and indicative timelines. This framework should be part of the SURGE Plan.

6. SURGE mechanism

a. SURGE planning

The SURGE mechanism was immediately activated (2 weeks after the L2 declaration the SURGE planning mission arrived in Bangladesh, at the end of October). The Plan was generally endorsed by the CB in mid-November. The SURGE Plan identifies opportunities for an integrated recovery framework for around USD 25 millions in 18 months, structured around 4 main areas:

- Increasing livelihoods and economic opportunities;
- Supporting host and refugee communities to manage environmental and disaster risks;
- Managing social risks through strengthened protection mechanisms for vulnerable communities; and
- Strengthening local capacities in assessing and responding to needs for effective service delivery and inclusive recovery.

These roughly correspond to the 4 pillars of the Strategy that the CO will develop later on. The SURGE phase cost was estimated at approximately USD 750,000. In fact, the total cost amounts to USD 796,000. This is due mostly to the use of consultants for many positions, which reduced the overall cost despite extension of some positions. The CO requested an extension of the SURGE phase to 6 months, which was granted in March. Deactivation of the level 2 and formal closure of the SURGE phase in fact took place in September 2018.

Given the scale of the emergency and the CO capacity, it is worth considering if the SURGE phase should have not been of 6 months from the outset, above all because this has an impact on the length of the SURGE deployments and contributes to a high turnover which is destabilizing and should be avoided to the extent possible.

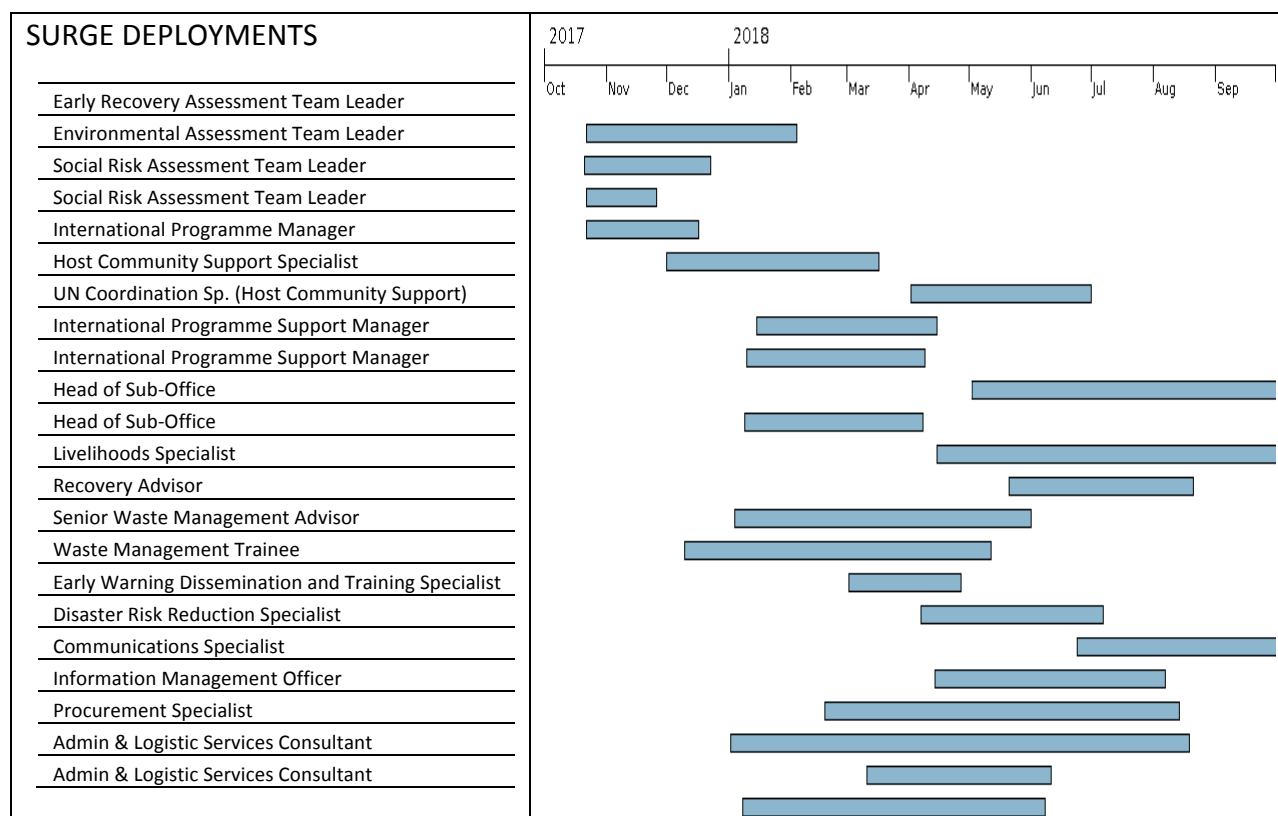
b. SURGE deployments

The CO generally considers the support provided by SURGE deployments as positive (with some exceptions) and that it was useful to boost CO capacity.

The SURGE Plan identified 15 positions²² (including to the 3 initial assessments team leaders) for the response. These were planned for 3 months, with the possibility of extension to 6 months for some. In the end, 22 people were deployed (some repeatedly or switching positions) for the entire SURGE phase. The first positions were deployed relatively quickly after the approval of the SURGE plan, with the exception of the Head of Sub-Office (HoSO) which deployed in January - a strategic position that should have been filled in much earlier. The majority of other SURGE positions were first deployed between January and April (not counting extensions), towards the end of the initial SURGE phase. The Early Warning D&T Specialist and DRR Specialists were fully-funded deployments offered by RedR Australia and MSB in recognition of the pressing overall need, specifically to UNDP due to its established technical advisory role. An additional deployment of a Disaster Risk Specialist agreed in August 2018 is not included below as the deployment started in November 2018 (therefore outside the scope of the present AAR).

Deployments were triggered at different moments, according to the need:

²² In this section we identify all as SURGE deployees, regardless if they are UNDP staff or recruited as consultants, unless the contractual modality is relevant to the point discussed.



UNDP’s decision to deploy assessment experts immediately, even before the SURGE planning mission, was right and potentially a game changer, had the assessments achieved the desired effect of creating a space for UNDP’s intervention and showing UNDP’s analytical contribution, rapidity of implementation and programming niche. It was very unfortunate that the assessments for various reasons did not go as planned, but the initial idea was impeccable.

Several deployees that have joined the Bangladesh response are senior, high-caliber figures with long experience in UNDP and whose support was generally well received. Technical specialists from stand-by partners (MSB and Red-R) were also considered very professional and very useful for the response. In addition to the quality of individual deployees, UNDP could look into increasing deployments from Regional Bureaus / Regional Hubs, as regional support benefits from a better knowledge of the country context and can be more immediately operative than deployees with potentially lesser knowledge of the context.

R: Assess the advantages, costs and modalities of increasing regional deployments (from Regional Bureaus and Hub, but also from other CO in the region, or consultants from the region); assess the advantages and costs of developing regional SURGE rosters.

Some positions were not fully implemented as planned in the SURGE,²³ and some were diverted to CXB: the Resilience and Recovery Programme Manager (RRPM) position was deployed to Cox’s Bazar instead than Dhaka as originally planned; the RRPM and GPM positions were transformed respectively into International Programme Manager and International Programme Support Manager, and subsequently merged into one position. Throughout the response the CO could have benefitted from a coordinator in Dhaka who could support management; with time the CO has recognized the usefulness of having a bridge position between the CO and the SO, and in fact the current “International Programme Support Manager” has been regularly

²³ The Recovery and Resilience Programme Manager/International Programme Manager; the Governance Programme Manager/International Programme Support Manager (later merged with the RRPM).

“shuttling” between the two offices – and all parties involved recognize that the presence at both levels was very helpful as it facilitated coordination. This indicates that the original intention in the SURGE Plan, to have coordinating and advisory functions based in Dhaka, was the right choice.

The Head of Sub-Office position was filled later than advisable. This is a strategic position for UNDP; people deployed were considered of high quality and feedback is positive; however, the first ‘formal’ HoSO arrived in country in January and was initially deployed to support the RC Office on a review of the coordination structure, in fact assuming functions at the end of January. Diverting such a key position for several weeks in a time-sensitive situation like the first few months of an emergency is not desirable. Several external stakeholders have indicated how the frequent turnover of lead staff heading UNDP office in CXB has not contributed to consolidate UNDP’s presence and role. In fact, in CXB there have been to date 5 people “in charge” (regardless of the specific title they had at the time)²⁴ and at the time of the AAR the position was vacant, although recruitment was being finalized.

SURGE Coordinator and SURGE CO Focal Point. The SURGE coordinator was never officially appointed but according to the CO, in practice the HoSO acted as SURGE Coordinator, while the DCD acted as the CO SURGE Focal Point. Some informants reflect that a separate CO Focal Point would have been a better option, given the already vast responsibility of the CO management in managing the entire CO programmes, and the intensive demands of SURGE/Rohingya response coordination – this observation is consistent with others’ suggestions to have a senior figure supporting CO management on the Rohingya response.

Timing, sequencing and length of deployments could be improved. As the graph above shows, the majority of the positions were deployed starting January; this is somehow to be expected as it is difficult to deploy staff just before the festive season; however this effectively delayed UNDP’s engagement in full force until the beginning of 2018. Delays in an emergency are expensive in terms of positioning of an agency.

At the end of April there was a break as the first wave of deployments ended; ideally this should be avoided not to destabilize the response by fragmenting SURGE support, however it is not always possible to ensure continuity. Ideally, an overlap of a few days should be guaranteed between successive incumbents of the same position; this was not always the case. In the case of Bangladesh, it should have been clear from the beginning that the SURGE phase was likely to last at least six months – given the scale of the crisis and the capacity of the CO to respond. A longer initial timeframe would have allowed for longer contracts for SURGE employees, which would have been a better solution especially for key positions, avoiding high turnover.

Although it is difficult to plan ahead, it would be ideal to sequence deployments consistently with the availability of funding to take maximum advantage of them. One case in point is communications: the person deployed did not have many active projects to communicate upon and therefore to some extent the resource could not be fully taken advantage of.

There have been some mentions of slowness from CO side in the recruiting processes (for example interviews and selection of candidates) but it has not been possible to obtain precise data to verify this assertion.

More precise guidance for employees is recommended to allow them to perform at the best of their capacity. Some responders report that the Terms of Reference (TORs) for SURGE employees were either not specific enough with generic deliverables or were never adapted to the actual work that needed to be done. Some employees reportedly consider having been ‘underutilized’. In evaluations where staff was not

²⁴ Paul Bonnard initially in October 2017, Rhonda Gossen starting in December, Jan Jilles van Hoeven from January 2018 and Trond Husby from April 2018 (the longest deployment); the position was vacant at the time of the field visit and in charge was the Programme Manager, Mir Asgar, a highly respected Bangladeshi with many years of experience in emergency management in Bangladesh and outside.

considered fully successful, the lack of clarity of the ToRs is indicated as one of the reasons. It is a good practice to ensure that ToRs are revised at the beginning of a deployment between the deployee and supervisor and tailored to the situation, identifying tangible deliverables and outputs. During the AAR workshop some observed that an orientation in country before deployment would have been very useful for deployees, especially considering the difficult working environment some of them would face. The Crisis Bureau delivered pre-departure orientation to 11 out of 15 deployees.

R: Ensure a mandatory revision and fine-tuning of the ToRs with the supervisor on the first days of deployment; provide a remote orientation (by CB / RBAP) to deployees and an in-country orientation (by CO) at the beginning of the deployment.

Matching of skills and profiles. Two of the deployments have been given mixed assessments as they were senior, competent staff, very engaged and with strong personalities, but likely not matched well with the requirement of the position they covered – in particular soft skills and capacity to listen and to create consensus. There have been many observations from stakeholders interviewed (internal and external) about the tensions in which these staff were involved, to the point that the RC and the CO tried to mitigate the situation by switching incumbents of the two positions, with the intention of better matching deployees profiles and strengths to the roles; however, some damage had already been caused: Host Community coordinators were not considered *super partes* by other agencies but focusing to UNDP interests instead, they were not considered collaborative and overall contributed to the difficulties explained above regarding HC coordination. It should be noted that at least one of these positions was modified with respect to the initial SURGE plan; also that staff deployed were senior figures likely more adequate for strategic advisory roles at central level than operational or coordination ones.

There is not at the moment a mechanism within the Crisis Bureau to assess soft skills of potential deployees (UNDP has a roster of experts of over 3,500 and manages around 400 deployments per year so individual assessments are not an option); however this appears to be more and more necessary for strategic and advisory functions (also compared to other AAR this author has led) – technical deployments seem not to have raised the same issues, probably because these skills are less essential for a successful performance.

R: Crisis Bureau to assess possible modalities to assess soft skills of deployees like communication, capacity to influence, capacity to work with people and others; emphasize on this aspect on evaluation requested to supervisors after deployments.

The system for evaluations of SURGE deployees presents some complications. There was an instance of a SURGE deployee not considered successful and that was apparently also not successful in a previous deployment, however the concerned CO reportedly did not provide a precise evaluation; the following, unsuccessful deployment was to Bangladesh.

There is also a difference in evaluation among surge deployees, depending on their contractual modality: consultants are evaluated by the supervisor according to a template provided by the Crisis Bureau, while UNDP staff deployed are only evaluated “informally” (i.e. verbally and in practice only if there is any concern to report). Reportedly, this is due to a concern that evaluations would not be kept confidential, therefore a negative evaluation could become known and potentially have professional consequences in the future. Finally, when the author of this AAR requested her own evaluation from previous assignments, she was referred to the former supervisor; this not having direct access to her own evaluation as recorded in the system.

All these issues are problematic and point to the need of improving the evaluation system and make it more transparent and inclusive. Avoiding evaluations or having one-sided evaluations are not good practices and do not contribute to professional growth. Evaluations and feedback should not be feared but managed appropriately.

R: Review the evaluation and recommendation practices of SURGE deployees, developing a common evaluation system regardless of the contractual modality; encourage a “debriefing session / final discussion” between supervisee and supervisor at the end of a deployment, where feedback should be provided on the performance. The Crisis Bureau could provide guidance on how to conduct these feedback discussions, and if necessary even convene and participate in them.

Exit strategy and absorption of SURGE positions after the end of the SURGE phase. As SURGE is a temporary support, UNDP offices must consider the exit strategy from the start, so that positions are mainstreamed in CO structure (if pertinent) or simply end. Compared to other crises the SURGE phase lasted longer and several positions were extended, giving sufficient time to organize the transition. The exit strategy was initially discussed in the CSMT in June 2018; in the end several positions have been absorbed into the CO structure, some temporarily supported by the Crisis Bureau for one additional year in co-sharing agreement with UNHCR or with RBAP. In total, 4 positions for the moment are funded externally (Crisis Bureau, RBAP, UNHCR, MSB), 6 are funded through project funding and 2 more if funding becomes available, 1 will be budgeted in future proposals.²⁵

7. Programmatic and operational response

a. Programmes

The CO developed a 2018-2020 strategy based on 4 main areas: (1) Governance, public service delivery and rule of law; (2) Community cohesion, security and conflict prevention; (3) Inclusive recovery and development; (4) Environmental sustainability and DRR.

The strategy recognized early on that a protracted scenario could not be excluded and highlights the importance to support host community and local governments in facing the impact of the crisis. It includes six “Principles of work”: repurpose existing programmes, focus on host communities, work with others, stick to mandate and comparative advantage, support analysis, and contribute to localization of the response.

Whilst the strategy reflected three phases for UNDP’s engagement in a crisis (immediate crisis response, transition phase long term) it gave insufficient detail on the humanitarian-development nexus which is a concept and an approach that has not been fully defined in Bangladesh. The strategy was finalized in April 2018; it is accompanied by 26 concept notes for potential projects for donor funding. Some respondents have indicated how the development of UNDP strategy and concept notes without broad consultation with other partners has raised tensions with other agencies. As the CO strategy formulation was done rapidly, the CO could have reviewed it to reflect contextual changes and collaboration with the humanitarian community.

²⁵ The Cox’s Bazar office will be led by an international P5 position (cost-shared Crisis Bureau /RBAP for one year, then project-based), which is under recruitment; the international programme manager and the programme support manager functions have been merged; the CO plans to continue with the position with project funding; The UN Coordination/Host Community position will be co-funded by UNHCR and the Crisis Bureau for one year (although UNHCR has manifested this is contingent on funding availability on their side); for the Livelihoods specialist position, the CO is planning to hire a consultant, pooled from several ongoing (non-CXB) projects; the Recovery Advisor position and the two Admin/Logs/Common Services are continuing with project funding; Waste Management Specialist position is funded through project funding, while two more positions are provided by MSB; the DRR Specialist position will be budgeted in a future multi-year project on DRR, to be developed; the Communication and the IM positions will be considered for continuation if project funding is available.

R: CO management to provide strategic guidance for the review the 2018-2020 strategy in light of changing context and existing projects, focusing on opportunities to build upon current programmes, on the humanitarian-development nexus and on longer-term recovery planning.

At the beginning of the response, some informants report that the coordination between the CO pillars on governance, poverty and environment to design a coherent response to the crisis was weak, as well as the coordination between the CO programme experts and the new Cox's Bazar team. This has reportedly improved over time.

UNDP engaged immediately in three assessments in collaboration with UN Women, to identify key needs and gaps and open a space for its interventions. The SURGE Planning Team drew on their preliminary observations when designing the SURGE plan.

- The environmental assessment was very well received; the draft of the Rapid Environmental Assessment (REA) was completed quickly but this report became public a long time afterwards. UNDP and the GoB were to publish the report jointly, but after several months the GoB withdrew and UNDP finally published the report on its own several months after the finalization of the assessment. While it would have not been possible to anticipate such conclusion, in the end it results in a missed opportunity for UNDP in rapidly providing good quality analysis to the Rohingya response community.
- The CO considered the Early Recovery Assessment of insufficient quality (although some respondents disagree on the quality reservations), and therefore it was never published, but only used internally.

The Social Risk Assessment could not be published given sensitivity challenges regarding its contents. Reportedly having very good quality of analysis and interesting insights, it looked at conflict drivers and touched on very sensitive issues, therefore it was to be shared with some modifications to allow for constructive discussions on delicate topics. However, a non-cleared copy was mistakenly shared causing tensions that resulted in the complete withdrawal of the assessment report.

- Key findings were used internally by UNDP to inform programming; there is conflicting information on the fate of the summary: according to informants in the CO even a lighter summary that was prepared for external distribution was not disseminated to avoid tensions; according to others a summary version was posted online via the ISCG and the full version was shared with a small group of donors.

In summary, of the three assessments that UNDP started, the results of one only were fully disseminated, many months later, while another was partially / informally disseminated. Except few persons aware of the social risk assessment incident, the majority of other stakeholders interviewed on this subject do not know what happened and many simply think UNDP never published them. The existence of the assessments created expectations from external partners that were not ultimately fulfilled, thus not contributing to increase UNDP's status and credibility as a reliable actor. On the positive side, since programmes were designed based on the results of these assessments, they reflect the needs identified and are highly relevant to the situation in Cox's Bazar.

At the moment, there is a similar impression among some regarding the impact assessment, as if these assessments too - which have been long in the making and for whose delay there are no public explanations - will end up never being published. Many other stakeholders are very interested in the results and expect them with anticipation. This is a very good opportunity for UNDP to assert its capacity to provide high quality analysis, it should not be wasted like it happened unfortunately with the first assessments. As recommended earlier, the CO should accelerate the conclusion and publication of the impact assessments.

At the end of September 2018, UNDP had the following projects under implementation (at various degrees of progress):²⁶

- C2RP (Rule of Law and Conflict prevention components)
- Support to Community Stabilization and Resilience
- Mapping of Social Risk to Inform Effective Response to Social Tensions in Cox's Bazar
- Ecosystem restoration
- Pilot project on livelihoods
- Disaster Risk Management (including extreme weather and disaster preparedness, and automated rain gauges)
- Sustainable Solutions to Solid Waste: A Local Response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh

Until September 2018, approximately 60% of the funds mobilized were for environmental sustainability and DRR, with a significant percentage devoted to solid waste management and local governance.

As reported elsewhere, UNDP started its response by drawing from existing projects and resources, and building upon existing mechanisms, which was a smart strategic choice that has contributed to faster implementation.

- In particular, UNDP has built upon the Early Recovery Facility (ERF, now called DRRF), which was about to conclude in 2017 and has been extended to mid 2018 as ERF to channel the response through the existing mechanism. The ERF/DRRF has a Key findings were used internally by UNDP to inform programming; there is conflicting information on the fate of the summary: according to informants in the CO even a lighter summary that was prepared for external distribution was not disseminated to avoid tensions; according to others a summary version was posted online via the ISCG and the full version was shared with a small group of donors.

In summary, of the three assessments that UNDP started, the results of one only were fully disseminated, many months later, while another was partially / informally disseminated. Except few persons aware of the social risk assessment incident, the majority of other stakeholders interviewed on this subject do not know what happened and many simply think UNDP never published them. The existence of the assessments created expectations from external partners that were not ultimately fulfilled, thus not contributing to increase UNDP's status and credibility as a reliable actor. On the positive side, since programmes were designed based on the results of these assessments, they reflect the needs identified and are highly relevant to the situation in Cox's Bazar.

At the moment, there is a similar impression among some regarding the impact assessment, as if these assessments too - which have been long in the making and for whose delay there are no public explanations - will end up never being published. Many other stakeholders are very interested in the results and expect them with anticipation. This is a very good opportunity for UNDP to assert its capacity to provide high quality analysis, it should not be wasted like it happened unfortunately with the first assessments. As recommended earlier, the CO should accelerate the conclusion and publication of the impact assessments.

At the end of September 2018, UNDP had the following projects under implementation (at various degrees of progress):²⁷

- C2RP (Rule of Law and Conflict prevention components)
- Support to Community Stabilization and Resilience
- Mapping of Social Risk to Inform Effective Response to Social Tensions in Cox's Bazar
- Ecosystem restoration

²⁶ An overview of some of the current projects implemented by the CO is included in Annex VIII.

²⁷ An overview of some of the current projects implemented by the CO is included in Annex VIII.

- Pilot project on livelihoods
- Disaster Risk Management (including extreme weather and disaster preparedness, and automated rain gauges)
- Sustainable Solutions to Solid Waste: A Local Response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh

Until September 2018, approximately 60% of the funds mobilized were for environmental sustainability and DRR, with a significant percentage devoted to solid waste management and local governance.

As reported elsewhere, UNDP started its response by drawing from existing projects and resources, and building upon existing mechanisms, which was a smart strategic choice that has contributed to faster implementation.

- In particular, UNDP has built upon the Early Recovery Facility (ERF, now called DRRF), which was about to conclude in 2017 and has been extended to mid 2018 as ERF to channel the response through the existing mechanism. The ERF/DRRF has a roster of rapid response experts, but several people have commented that the roster is out of date. There is a good opportunity to update the roster in the context of the current crisis response;
- Efficient and Accountable Local Governance (EALG) project: Cox's Bazar was not a project area for the EALG, however it was agreed in principle that the project could extend its work in Teknaf and Ukhia subject to availability of funding, which has recently been granted (Switzerland, 1 million CHF for 4 years 2019-2022);
- Strengthening Inclusive Development in the Chittagong Hill Tracts (SID-CHT). The CO has an extensive project in CHT on natural resources, livelihoods and social cohesion; the team from SID-CHT project was used for activities in Cox's Bazar – for example the forestry expert to design the environmental rehabilitation project; and additional Farmers field schools were funded by Denmark. In addition, the SID-CHT project is assisting the C2RP project on mapping of local conflicts and existing conflict management practices.
- The UNDP CO had a UNDP-DPA Joint Programme asset that they took advantage of to design, staff up and implement the conflict analysis.

Three programmatic areas are notable: solid waste management, disaster risk management, and conflict prevention:

- UNDP had identified a possible niche in solid waste management (SWM) in one of its first interventions: the cash for work / livelihoods project implemented by Action Aid Bangladesh. This was recognized as an important gap in the response which UNDP is now covering
- The recognized expertise UNDP has in disaster risk management in the country has been instrumental in positioning it for DRM activities also in the context of the Rohingya response.
- Finally, UNDP has identified a niche in conflict analysis. According to some stakeholders, the response was initially conflict-blind and the social risk analysis conducted by UNDP, UN Women and the UNDP-DPA Joint Programme, particularly on the political economy of the crisis and the refugee response was instrumental in ensuring more conflict-sensitive programming. This is a very useful input that UNDP contributed to the response community, and it should continue to build on this niche.

The scale of the response might not have been commensurate to the level of the crisis. Several respondents (both internal and external) have highlighted how the scale of the response and level of ambition might not have been proportionate to the level of the crisis, and that UNDP lagged behind others. In fact, even UNDP documents state “getting started on a *modest* response” (emphasis added) comprising of initial assessment, small pilots on cash for work and solid waste management, DRR technical support and host community support and coordination. While the initial modest approach might have been justified by

limited presence and funding, there should have been a stronger push for more rapid scale-up later; it appears that UNDP is getting traction only now, more than one year after the beginning of the crisis.

The rapidity of the response was insufficient to help positioning UNDP within the humanitarian ecosystem. There is a frequent observation that the response has been quite slow and UNDP has taken a long time to set itself in motion *significantly* (i.e. beyond minimal engagement or initial assessments). This relates both to the involvement directly in the response and in the influence and strategic thinking on development implications of the crisis. At the end of 2018 the situation has definitely improved, with the launch of a few projects and much more funding available for others. The CO has observed during the AAR workshop that the approval of the annual work plans and the release of funding could be improve, and that programme planning could be strengthened.

More support is desirable on local governance. Several internal and external stakeholders have observed that UNDP could have provided more support to the local administration to manage the response (beyond the staff provided with initial funding to strengthen local authorities offices, and with sustaining the focus on host communities despite the adverse opinions of others), and that it should focus on governance support, a demand reportedly coming also from authorities. Support to District Development Plans should have started earlier. UNDP is planning to engage with the District after the finalization of the impact assessments.

R: Evaluate the opportunity to expand local governance support, and accelerate engagement on the Cox's Bazar district development planning.

b. Operations

The CO established in February 2018 a Sub-Office in Cox's Bazar. This was a key strategic decision and its implementation has been one of the successful elements of the response.

The advantage of having a field presence was somewhat reduced by the small number of UNDP staff, particularly because operational matters were managed in Dhaka. With time, however, operations staff were assigned to the Sub-Office and even based in Cox's Bazar for periods; however the CO observes that operational support to the Sub-Office would be more useful if more streamlined. Special measures available in case of crisis response were not known by all relevant staff and therefore there have been instances of unnecessary use of longer procedures.

Another strategic and successful operational decision was to use the existing CO resources, for example logistics support from the CHDTF team and the use of the ERF mechanism (now called DRRF) as the crisis response vehicle. This facilitated operations because it proved less bureaucratic and less burdensome than the national implementation modality. In fact, one operation staff under the DRRF was assigned to support the Rohingya response.

In addition to Rohingya crisis- related operations, the CO provided operational support to RC office and some other agencies (for example OCHA when they were present, and to the RCO) absorbing some resources to deliver this service.

Some respondents have indicated that initially some of the contracts for SURGE staff in Cox's Bazar were extremely short term (one month), which was detrimental to staff motivation and cause a great deal of job insecurity. The issue was later solved.

Delays in procurement were mentioned in more than one occasion as a challenge. These are reportedly linked to limited knowledge of emergency procedures or to excessive caution in decision-making; some staff reportedly were not aware of the change in policy by which previous fast-track procedures have been mainstreamed and can now be used by all COs. It is also important that in an emergency the right balance is

found between speed of reaction and procedures to follow; in fact slowness of UNDP is one of the major criticisms it receives. Often, the cost of taking a decision late is higher than the cost of making a mistake but operating quickly (mistakes can be corrected, delays cannot be undone).

It goes beyond the scope of this AAR to provide an in-depth analysis of procurement practices within the Bangladesh CO, however the fact that multiple respondents would raise this issue should prompt the CO to analyze its procurement procedures and practice and identify possible ways for improvement, as well as provide if necessary a training on streamlined procurement policies and procedures available within UNDP system.

R: CO to review procurement procedures and identify areas for improvement; RBAP, the Crisis Bureau in coordination with BMS Regional Procurement Specialist to provide to the CO / Operations team a brief training / webinar on procedures that can be used in case of emergency and where further guidance can be found (like the intranet crisis portal).

8. Resource mobilization and communications

a. Resource mobilization

Resource mobilization (RM) efforts have been quite successful but have materialized late, affecting UNDP's capacity to deliver significant results in the first year of the response.

The CO used the Strategy Note and associated Concept Notes as resource mobilization tools. The CO reports immediately engaging with donors, from the outset of the response in November 2017; it did not develop a resource mobilization strategy *per se*, but used the chapeau document (Strategy Note) as a RM tool identifying its main areas of engagement and specific projects; for each of these a concept note was developed (26 in total). Developing a strategy is a good practice that should be commended and replicated; while requiring significant effort, it helps in clarifying and articulating the CO vision, and facilitates dialogue with donors. The strategy was finalized in April, somewhat late, however in the first months of the response some donors were strongly focused on emergency activities. This strengthens the importance of developing a solid resource mobilization strategy. One of the SURGE deployees focused on RM and new programme development in the first months of assignment; elaborating multiple concept notes which later proved successful as RM tools.

Some donors have indicated that the vast number of concept notes presented by UNDP gave the impression of the intention to chase funding wherever available. UNDP prepared a total of 26 concept notes for different aspects of the response.

The CO resource mobilization targets for 2018-2020 amount to USD 87.5 million (USD 32,3 million for Environmental sustainability and Disaster Management, 27,9 for Inclusive recovery and development, 20 for Governance and Rule of Law and 7.3 for Community Cohesion). The SURGE Plan indicates an amount of up to USD 25 million for an integrated recovery framework for 18 months.

The CO has mobilized approximately USD 10.4 million, with another 8 million in the pipeline (data until September 2018; at the time of writing, additional funds confirmed include Canada, Switzerland and UK, bringing the grand total to USD 17.8 millions).²⁸ Until the end of September 2018 the overall distribution of

²⁸ Different UNDP stakeholders evaluate the approximately 10.4 millions raised for the response on a spectrum from 'successful' to 'average'. If evaluated against the target that the CO itself set (over 87 million), it is approximately 12.5%; if evaluated against the SURGE Plan indicative

funding among the 4 pillars is the following: 74% to Pillar 4, 18% to Pillar 1 and 2 combined, 8% to Pillar 3. Both governance and livelihoods have received little funding compared to other areas. In the following months and with the newly approved resources from Canada, Switzerland and UK, the funding will be more balanced among the four pillars of UNDP's response.

Resource Mobilization - UNDP Bangladesh			UP TO 30 SEPT 2018
Initial funding (kick-off of the response)			
	Donor	Funds already mobilized	Funds in pipeline
Crisis Bureau	UNDP	\$100.000,00	
Crisis Bureau	UNDP	\$100.000,00	
Crisis Bureau	UNDP	\$25.000,00	
CHINA	UNDP	\$448.211,00	
BPPS	UNDP	\$500.000,00	
SUBTOTAL INITIAL FUNDING		\$1.173.211,00	\$0,00
Pillar 1 - Governance, Public Service Delivery and Global Rule of Law			
Pillar 2 - Inclusive Recovery and Development			
	Donor	Funds mobilized	Funds in pipeline
Community Recovery and Resilience (C2RP)	Global Rule of Law Programme	\$400.000,00	
Community Recovery and Resilience (C2RP)	Conflict Prevention Sub-window	\$400.000,00	
Support to Community Stabilization and Resilience	Germany	\$900.000,00	
Strengthening local governance for improved service delivery (extension of EALG)	Switzerland		\$1.000.000,00
SUBTOTAL PILLARS 1 AND 2		\$1.700.000,00	\$1.000.000,00
Pillar 3 - Community cohesion, Security and Conflict prevention			
	Donor	Funds mobilized	Funds in pipeline
PTIB: Mapping of Social Risk to Inform Effective Response to Social Tensions in Cox's Bazar	Netherlands	\$700.000,00	
PTIB: Mapping of Social Risk to Inform Effective Response to Social Tensions in Cox's Bazar	Norway		\$700.000,00
Community cohesion, Security and Conflict prevention	Canada		\$4.600.000,00
Social cohesion and women empowerment, access to justice and strengthening the national system response (joint w UNW)	UK		\$300.000,00
SUBTOTAL PILLAR 3		\$700.000,00	\$5.600.000,00
Pillar 4 - Environmental sustainability and Disaster risk management			
	Donor	Funds mobilized	Funds in pipeline
Ecosystem restoration	Denmark	\$1.200.000,00	
Pilot livelihood improvement of rural women	UNHCR	\$32,600.00	
Automated rain gauges for landslide risk monitoring	UNHCR	\$60.000,00	

amount of 25 millions, is a little less than 50%. Now that Canadian and Swiss funding have been approved – although beyond the scope of the present review – the picture is significantly rosier.

Extreme weather and disaster preparedness	ECHO	\$700.000,00	
"Sustainable Solutions to Solid Waste: A Local Response to the Rohingya Crisis in Bangladesh"	Sweden	\$4.800.000,00	
Extreme weather and disaster preparedness	UNHCR		\$230.000,00

A lesson learnt in previous crises is the effectiveness of the initial funds²⁹ if used as seed funding for quick, impactful high-visibility activities (generally as pilots) to attract the interest of donors by showcasing UNDP's capacity to deliver. Speed of implementation is also of the essence: in an emergency rapidity of delivery even on small scale is valued more and provides more credit than larger initiatives that take too long to materialize.

In the case of Bangladesh the seed funding was partially effective. The SWM pilot did bring in additional 4.8 million from SIDA; however, the three assessments were not as successful. The idea was good: investing in assessments to justify – based on the results – the need for specific interventions, create a space for UNDP, and proportion good quality analysis to the community of responders. As described earlier, the assessments were either delayed or partially / informally shared, and therefore this investment did not pay off as much as it could have. Nevertheless, the social risk assessment paved the way for funding from Netherlands, Germany and Norway.

The majority of the funding mobilized by the CO was approved towards the end of the first year of the response. Some donors have acknowledged that the agreement on funding and subsequent disbursement have taken 4 or 5 months. For example, discussions with Switzerland started in March, while the funding was approved in November (8 months). This prevented UNDP from having results to show for several months and in turn reduced its standing with other organizations. UNDP was not part of the first Humanitarian Response Plan, with the first SURGE Advisor arriving after the approval of the HRP by the Government. Instead later on UNDP achieved 4 proposals of the 5 submitted to the Joint Response Plan (JRP March to December 2018). ECHO funds were available from October 2017, however problems within the consortium delayed the implementation of some activities until mid-2018. In fact, UNDP pursued DRR technical advisory activities as outlined in the ECHO proposal with own funding, staff and SURGE deployees from Jan 2018, while awaiting ECHO funds; the contract between IOM (consortium leader) and UNDP was completed in August 2018 and activities on local government capacity building commenced from Sep 2018.

Some informants object that because UNDP focus is mostly (although not exclusively) on recovery, it should not be expected to get funding earlier in the response. However, in various occasions reviewed by this author UNDP has mobilized (or intended to mobilize) funds from CERF and from Flash Appeals within the first 6 months of a response; it has also been able to receive major recovery funding three months after the onset of a crisis.³⁰ Therefore it is possible and in fact better to mobilize funding earlier and start implementation of activities sooner. Also, if UNDP engages in activities to support host communities, they should initiate as early as possible since host communities are affected by a crisis from the beginning; finally, some of the projects that the CO itself implements are either through humanitarian funds (ECHO) or in a humanitarian context (solid waste management in refugee camps), which are equally recommendable for an early start. Early recovery work can be initiated immediately or almost immediately within a crisis response; a solid stand of the organization as a reliable partner (which is often facilitated by sufficient early funding) contributes to possible further funding later; finally, the diffuse perception on UNDP slowness earlier discussed is also a consequence of limited funding available at the initial stages and throughout the first year of the response.

In future crises, it is advisable that CO management provides strategic guidance and if necessary close follow-up and support to early resource mobilization efforts, as earliest availability of funding and immediate implementation are instrumental for UNDP's positioning in a crisis response. If necessary, more support or specific technical support can be asked to BERA.

²⁹ Often those provided by the Crisis Bureau in the initial weeks of a response.

³⁰ Data collected on communications was quite limited outside of the CO. Several staff invited to provide their views declined to participate arguing that they had not been involved significantly in the response, or did not answer requests for contribution.

b. Communications ³⁰

Initial communications activities were cautious due to the sensitivity of the situation. In October 2017, given the sensitivity of the situation and the political implications, BERA suggested limiting external communications on the crisis; at the same time, it contributed to developing key messages for the RC on the Rohingya crisis.

The CO developed a Communications Strategy with the support of the SURGE deployment. The CO was supported by a SURGE deployment of 3.5 months; during this time a Communication strategy was developed for the period July-December 2018, in view of being later integrated into the CO Communications Strategy in 2019. The Communications Strategy identifies goals, target audience, key messages and channels for communication, as well as a timeline for activities. Some informants have expressed reservations on the quality of the strategy itself, and for example it shows limited linkages to resource mobilization, nevertheless it should be recognized that the development of a customized communication strategy in the first months of a crisis is a good practice that should be always pursued (with the opportune quality). Since the majority of UNDP funding was received in the second half of the year under review, and many projects have just recently started implementation, there was limited scope for a full-time deployment in April, when the communications specialist did have not a lot of material (project activities, achievements) to communicate upon.

It was also noted that the expert deployed did not have significant previous emergency experience, which according to some respondents made the deployment less effective in the context of the Rohingya crisis, which made the tours of global media for many weeks.

There are different views on UNDP's visibility. The CO observed during the AAR report that the media coverage was good, particularly on social media and on national media. At the same time, almost every major UN agency has sent its highest representative to visit the Rohingya camps in Bangladesh (just to indicate a few: the Secretary General of the UN, the Executive Directors of WFP, UNICEF, UNFPA, UN Women, the High Commissioner for Refugees, the IOM Director General, the President of the World Bank); but UNDP has not mobilized at the same level. This could be interpreted by outsiders (including donors) as lower engagement of the Agency in this response, compared to others. UNDP was cognizant initially that this was a humanitarian response and was also fully aware of the time and effort needed for these visits from the RCO and other UN agencies. Hence, once UNDP had started implemented projects and had results to show, the RBAP Regional Director and ASG, Haoliang Xu visited Cox's Bazar and the Rohingya Camps on 24 March 2018 and met with the ISCG, Cox's Bazar SO Heads, the NGOs (international and national) and with some UNDP project beneficiaries.

Several informants (particularly donors and other humanitarian organizations) have manifested limited information-sharing by UNDP: this regards knowledge of UNDP projects, or the progress of certain activities (for example the current impact assessments), of the reasons behind delays in implementation or challenges encountered; others have expressed that UNDP does not consult or share information sufficiently. This is detrimental first of all for UNDP as it can affect its credibility as a reliable partner. There seems to be a good opportunity to increase communication, consultation and information-sharing with partners and donors on UNDP's work, its successes and the challenges it faces. Communication should be both targeted to key actors on specific matters, and broader for the humanitarian and development community.

R: Ensure that in all relevant fora (including especially at SEG with donors and key partners), progress updates are given on key activities; Develop a bimonthly bulletin for updates on UNDP's activities for external distribution.

9. Conclusions and recommendations

a. Conclusions

The overall assessment of UNDP's response to the Rohingya refugee crisis is mixed. Some aspects were (and are) successful, others could have been managed better.

All parties expressed overall positive feedback on internal coordination within the CO and between the CO, regional and global bureaus, with regular exchange of information, strategic advice and the necessary follow up when required. RBAP was strongly involved since the beginning of the response, provided support on multiple fronts. Now that the SURGE phase has concluded, the CO still faces what has become a protracted crisis, which might require in the future more (or different) support.

Interagency coordination has been significantly more problematic. The unique structure of interagency coordination in Bangladesh has certainly influenced UNDP's space; however there have been significant difficulties not only linked to the resistance found, but also to UNDP's own management of the host community coordination issue. In fact, UNDP has not been successful so far in achieving its desired role on host community coordination. On the other side, UNDP's role in Disaster Risk Reduction has been easily acknowledged within the humanitarian community.

Leadership of the response has been positive, but with some challenges at CO level. A combination of factors including unavoidable temporary absences and limited emergency experience at management level, coupled with extraordinary difficulties within the context that would have required a firmer leadership, an early detection of such strategic support to the CO management, for instance by the Crisis Board, could have increased UNDP level of engagement in the early phase of the response.

Overall, the SURGE support provided to the CO is evaluated as positive, it has increased the CO capacity to address the crisis. There were some exceptions. At least four of the deployments have been evaluated as not fully successful; deployments should have started earlier and a high turnover in key positions should have been avoided.

The programmatic response is well designed and articulated, but the implementation started late. UNDP is providing interesting contributions to the response (for example the conflict analysis), but implementation should be accelerated to reposition the organization solidly and gain more credibility.

Finally, resource mobilization efforts have been quite successful but have materialized late in the year, affecting UNDP's capacity to deliver significant results in the first year of the response. The initial funding could have been used more successfully as seed funding.

The next chapters summarize recommendations to improve UNDP's response to crises, at CO level and at corporate level.

b. Summary of recommendations for UNDP globally

- ☑ In view of the protracted character of the crisis and its expected duration, the CO should identify any support requirements it foresees in the next year (and for longer if relevant); RBAP and the Crisis Bureau should provide orientation on what support is available at corporate level through protracted crisis mechanisms or what could be delivered as ad hoc support.
- ☑ Crisis Bureau and RBAP to provide technical guidance on promoting the humanitarian-development nexus and how it can be operationalized within the Rohingya crisis context, on livelihoods and on restoring local government functions.
- ☑ Review SOPs to include benchmarks and indicative timelines for the key moments of crisis response (corporate support activation, key CB meetings, SURGE Planning and so on).
- ☑ Develop an accountability framework with clear benchmarks between the CO, the corresponding Regional Bureau and the Crisis Bureau, on expected roles and responsibilities of each, milestones to be reached and indicative timelines. This framework should be part of the SURGE Plan.
- ☑ Evaluate levels of preparedness of CO and prioritize preparedness support to those with least capacity and highest risk of crises.
- ☑ Crisis Bureau to support Bangladesh CO in reaching a minimum level of additional preparedness, given existing risk of further crises (for example if a natural disaster happens in the area where refugees are hosted, or in case of a major epidemic outbreak).
- ☑ Assess the advantages, costs and modalities of increasing regional deployments (from Regional Bureaus and Hub, but also from other CO in the region, or consultants from the region); assess the advantages and costs of developing regional SURGE rosters.
- ☑ Ensure a mandatory revision and fine-tuning of the ToRs with the supervisor on the first days of deployment; provide a remote orientation (by CB / RBAP) to employees and an in-country orientation (by CO) at the beginning of the deployment.
- ☑ Crisis Bureau to assess possible modalities to assess soft skills of deployees like communication, capacity to influence, capacity to work with people and others; emphasize on this aspect on evaluation requested to supervisors after deployments.
- ☑ Review the evaluation and recommendation practices of SURGE deployees, developing a common evaluation system regardless of the contractual modality; encourage a “debriefing session / final discussion” between supervisee and supervisor at the end of a deployment, where feedback should be provided on the performance. The Crisis Bureau could provide guidance on how to conduct these feedback discussions, and if necessary even convene and participate in them.
- ☑ CO to review procurement procedures and identify areas for improvement; Crisis Bureau in coordination with BMS Regional Procurement Specialist to provide to the CO / Operations team a brief training / webinar on procedures that can be used in case of emergency and where further guidance can be found (like the intranet crisis portal).

c. Summary of recommendations for Bangladesh Country Office

- ☑ In view of the protracted character of the crisis and its expected duration, the CO should identify any support requirements it foresees in the next year (and for longer if relevant); RBAP and the Crisis Bureau should provide orientation on what support is available at corporate level through

protracted crisis mechanisms or what could be delivered as ad hoc support. [Note: the same recommendation is listed in the previous section for HQ/RBAP level]

- ☑ During coordination meetings/calls, increase focus on programmatic coordination and guidance on strategic decisions; strengthen linkage between programme management in Dhaka and in Cox's Bazar. Encourage CO missions to the SO.
- ☑ Update the CO Internal Control Framework to include the SO, indicating the division of roles and responsibilities between CO and SO; determine appropriate level of delegation and decentralization of responsibilities to the SO, to be reflected in the ICF and other relevant documents.
- ☑ Clarify implications of the "RC delinking" for the CO, potential immediate impact and any strategic measures necessary to take advantage of the process and minimize challenges.
- ☑ Ensure prioritization of attendance to SEG meetings at the highest representation level possible, providing regular feedback on UNDP's contribution for the response and open discussion with other decision-makers on strategic issues pertaining to UNDP's response and interagency coordination.
- ☑ Accelerate the recruitment of the "host community support" coordination position seconded to ISCG, ensuring the selected candidate has the required experience and skills to navigate the demands of the role; in addition consider temporarily covering the position with current CO staff.
- ☑ UNDP should re-evaluate how to best approach the coordination of host community support in a manner that is more acceptable to the rest of partners; UNDP should assess with UNHCR (as the co-funder) what is the best use for the HC Coordinator position and if it is still relevant to second it to ISCG; if seconded agree with ISCG what the role and responsibility would be and the support and collaboration it would receive.
- ☑ Develop a methodology for a comprehensive "host community support" mapping exercise and support ISCG in conducting it (or lead it if agreed).
- ☑ Given the importance of the Impact Assessment, CO management should closely follow the fast-tracking of their finalization and dissemination, to inform analysis and decisions on host community needs, area based programming and as an input for the elaboration of Cox's Bazar District Development Plan.
- ☑ Given the mutual interest in collaboration, affinity, and range of opportunities for joint programmes, UNDP should proactively explore closer collaboration and partners with UNHCR in particular on the humanitarian-development nexus and on longer-term aspects of the response.
- ☑ Ensure a mandatory revision and fine-tuning of the ToRs with the supervisor on the first days of deployment; provide a remote orientation (by CB / RBAP) to employees and an in-country orientation (by CO) at the beginning of the deployment. [Note: the same recommendation is listed in the previous section for HQ/RBAP level]
- ☑ CO management to provide strategic guidance for the review the 2018-2020 strategy in light of changing context and existing projects, focusing on opportunities to build upon current programmes, on the humanitarian-development nexus and on longer-term recovery planning. .
- ☑ Evaluate the opportunity to expand local governance support, and accelerate engagement on the Cox's Bazar district development planning.
- ☑ CO to review procurement procedures and identify areas for improvement; Crisis Bureau in coordination with BMS Regional Procurement Specialist to provide to the CO / Operations team a brief training / webinar on procedures that can be used in case of emergency and where further guidance can be found (like the intranet crisis portal). [Note: the same recommendation is listed in the previous section for HQ/RBAP level]

- ☑ Ensure that in all relevant fora (including especially at SEG and with donors and key partners), progress updates are given on key activities; Develop a bimonthly bulletin for updates on UNDP's activities for external distribution.

d. A final note

In conclusion, we would like to offer some more general observations: this author has conducted other AARs and it has noticed a few repeated challenges across countries and responses; the comments below are offered from a more general point of view and beyond the case of Bangladesh.³¹

COs' limited preparedness repeatedly comes up as a challenge that reduced their capacity of responding to crises. This can vary from senior management preparedness and knowledge of corporate mechanisms and support available, to staff knowledge of resources available (both programmatic and operation) and mechanisms that can be used, to speed of reaction which is often a combination of the above plus the capacity to switch to emergency mode from a slower 'development pace', and which is essential for UNDP's positioning.

Despite the progress made over the years, UNDP still struggles on being accepted within the humanitarian community and as a legitimate member at the crisis response table, and finds it very difficult to being given the space, priority and resources it deserves.

Delays in first deployments hinder the response; in addition, deployments not fully successful are often related to generic or inadequate ToRs and a mismatch between the positions and key skills required (often soft skills), and the profiles of persons deployed.

More support is usually needed on resource mobilization, from HQ and possibly as deployments, and more investment is required from the CO in comprehensive RM strategies.

In general, AARs results should be more proactively shared across the organization and some mechanism should be introduced to foment actual learning of the 'lessons learned'. One such tool could be the "Before Action Review" (BAR) supplemented by a compendium of lessons learned and key takeaways in similar crises. A "Before Action Review" is a sort of risk analysis taking place at the very beginning of a response, looking at all possible ways in which a response could go wrong, and taking opportune mitigating measures. The process, which can take place in half a day or even less, forces the reviewers to spot immediately the likely weaknesses that can affect the response and correct them before they become a hindrance; it is also a more proactive approach that identifies possible problems before they arise, rather than an approach counting on *post-facto* reflection and analysis which is by nature reactive. Former AARs of similar type of crises can be provided as inputs for reflection and would thus be more likely internalized by teams, promoting a more diffuse learning of the 'lessons learned'. The BAR could then serve as the basis for the Risk Assessment included in the SURGE Plan.

³¹ Three other AAR were conducted by the author, on very different contexts and crises; therefore, these do not represent trends but observations to keep in mind and compare with all other AARs promoted by the Crisis Bureau.

10. Annexes

a. Annex I – ToRs



DRAFT TOR AAR
Bangladesh_19 oct OK.doc

b. Annex II – Mission to Bangladesh

	Sunday 4 th	Monday 5 th	Tuesday 6 th	Wednesday 7 th	Thursday 8 th
08:00		Meetings with: Sida, USAID, UNHCR,	Half day workshop for internal UNDP, in the morning	Meetings with: RRRC (Govt), ISCG	Fly from CXB to Dhaka in the morning
09:00		Interviews with		UNW, ECHO, UNHCR, IOM, Action Aid	
10:00		Eva, Ameen,	Fly to CXB in the afternoon,		Any remaining meetings
11:00		Asgar (CXB staff);			
12:00		Skype with			De-brief with the CO
13:00		Mohammad			
14:00		Younus and	Meeting with the CXB team, and any other meetings possible with CXB-based org.		Skype with Bettina Woll (SURGE planning mission)
15:00		Tshering Pem (Bangkok Regional Hub)			
16:00	CO Senior Mgmt. (and if possible other CO staff)	Henny Ngu (SURGE planning mission)			Depart in the evening from Dhaka
17:00					
18:00					
19:00					

c. Annex III – List of stakeholders engaged

Name	Function	Organization	Method
UNDP Bangladesh & SURGE Deployments			
Mia Seppo	RC, Bangladesh	RC Office	KII
Sudipto Mukherjee	CD, Bangladesh	UNDP BGD/CXB	KII + AAR Workshop
Kyoko Yokosuka	DCD, Bangladesh	UNDP BGD/CXB	KII+ AAR Workshop
Cathrine Tranberg Haarsaker	Programme Manager, Disaster Risk Reduction Project	UNDP BGD/CXB	KII (CXB)
Shaila Khan	Assistant Country Director, Partnership Cluster	UNDP BGD/CXB	AAR Workshop
Md Abdul Quayyum	Communication Officer	UNDP BGD/CXB	AAR Workshop
Mariam Akther Rikta	Head of Procurement	UNDP BGD/CXB	AAR Workshop
Mohiuddin Ahmed	Head of Admin and Transport Services	UNDP BGD/CXB	AAR Workshop
Md. Sajjadul Chowdhury	Human Resources Associate & Head of HR	UNDP BGD/CXB	AAR Workshop
Khurshid Alam	Assistant Country Director	UNDP BGD/CXB	KII + AAR Workshop
Arif Abdullah Khan	Programme Analyst,	UNDP BGD/CXB	AAR Workshop

Saudia Anwer	Capacity Building Specialist	UNDP BGD/CXB	KII + AAR Workshop
Mahmuda Afroz	Programme Analyst, Governance Cluster		AAR Workshop
Jan-Jilles van der Hoeven	CXB Head of Sub-Office	SURGE	KII
Trond Husby	CXB Head of Sub-Office	SURGE	KII
Mir Ali Asgar	Programme Management Advisor, Cox's Bazar Programme	SURGE	KII + AAR Workshop
Alexandre Chaikine	Environmental Assessment TL	SURGE	KII
Rhonda Gossen	International Programme Manager / UN Coordination Specialist (Host Communities Support)	SURGE	KII
Maurice Dewulf	International Programme Manager / UN Coordination Specialist (Host Communities Support)	SURGE	KII
Ewelina Pusz	International Programme Support Manager	SURGE	KII + AAR Workshop
Faisal Ridwan	Waste Management Specialist,	SURGE	KII
Samer Abu Hawilih	Procurement / NGO Contracting Specialist	SURGE	KII
Edward Reece	Peace and Development Advisor	UNDP	KII
Staff at CXB	All present		meeting
UNDP HQ and RB			
Thierry Proteau	Programme Analyst	Crisis Bureau	KII
Bruno Lemarquis	Deputy Director	Crisis Bureau	KII
Bettina Woll	Team Leader Asia-Pacific team	Crisis Bureau	KII
Valerie Cliff	Deputy Director	RBAP	Email questionnaire
Mohammad Younus	Cluster Head	RBAP	KII
Ram Ier	Management Advisor	RBAP	KII
Jaco	Chief, Policy and Programme Support	BPPS	Email questionnaire
Henny Ngu	Policy specialist (livelihoods and displacements)	BPPS	KII
Yasumitsu Doken	Policy specialist (Crisis Coordination)	BPPS	KII
Naeun Choi	Partnership Analyst	BERA	Email questionnaire
Darshak Shah	Deputy Director	BMS	Email questionnaire
Nesreen Al-Hebshi	Management Specialist	BMS	Email questionnaire
Saumik De	Crisis Deployment Specialist	Crisis Bureau	KII
Rekha Das	Early recovery Support	Crisis Bureau	KII
Lin Cao	Liaison & Coordination Advisor	RBAP	Email questionnaire
Tshering Pem	Country Programme Specialist	RBAP	KII
Amy Gill	Policy specialist (Governance)	BPPS	KII
Tomislav Condic / Karell Inga	Regional Security Advisor	BMS	Email questionnaire
National authorities			
Mohammad Abul Kalam	RRRC		KII
Partners, Donors and others			
Tom Pope (and team)	Director, Democracy, Human Rights and Governance Office	USAID	KII
Papa Silla (and team)	Deputy Director	UNHCR	KII
Bernadethe Castel-Hollingsworth	Head of SubOffice, CXB	UNHCR	KII
Manuel Pereira	Head of SubOffice, CXB	IOM	KII
Luc Soenen, Tapane, Mokshir?	CXB	ECHO	KII

Flora Macula	Head of SubOffice, CXB	UN Women	KII
Abdul Alim	Humanitarian Coordinator CXB	Action Aid	KII
Annika Sandlund	ISCG Senior coordinator	ISCG	KII
Anders Ohrstrom	Sweden	Sweden	KII
Peter Agnew	FAO	FAO	KII

d. Annex IV – Key informant interview guidelines

Name:

Title:

Office/Unit:

Role in crisis response:

Date:

Questions

1. Can you please give me a brief overview of your role in the crisis response?
2. In your opinion, what are the key successes of this response?
3. For each of them, can you indicate the main enabling factors?
4. What were the key challenges encountered? What didn't work?
5. For each of the challenges, can you list one or more reasons?
6. *[In-depth questions depending on the role of the informant in the response – see data collection table]*
7. What are your key recommendations for UNDP's future crisis responses?
8. Is there anything else you would like to add?

Documents to be shared: ex. Informant ToRs, deliverables produced, other docs.

Thank you.

e. Annex V – AAR Workshop Agenda

A half-day AAR workshop will take place in Dhaka with UNDP staff, to foster debate on UNDP's response to the Rohingya crisis.

After the introduction and explanation of the methodology, the group will proceed to the first part of the AAR.

Two UNDP staff with support from the facilitator will be invited to “tell the story”. The first participant will explain “what we thought would happen”, in other words what were the planned objectives and expectations on the response. At the end, participants will have the opportunity to add to the narration. The second person will explain “what did actually happen”, relating the main events and decision as they unfolded. At the end, participants will also have the opportunity to add to the narration. This step will allow to all participants to have a clear and common understanding of the events, as during the crisis response different parts of the CO were engaged in different activities and might not be fully informed of all the aspects of the response.

The second part of the AAR consists in a division in groups (ideally 5 groups, but depending on number of participants), to explore the different aspects of the response. These are: SURGE mechanism, programmatic and operational response, internal and interagency coordination, management of the response and decision-making, communications and resource mobilization. Each group will discuss the assigned aspect by answering two main questions:

- What did we do well?
- What could have we done better or differently?

At the end, in the third part of the AAR workshop, each group will report back to the plenary and there will be an opportunity for further debate.

Agenda – AAR workshop

8:00 – Introductions, agenda and methodology

8:15 – Telling the story

8:45 – Division in groups and group work

10:15 – Coffee break

10:30 – Plenary and feedback from each group

11:30 – Debate

12:00 – Conclusion.

f. Annex VI – Timeline of events

External or interagency	Date	UNDP
	August 2017	
Beginning of massive Rohingya influx in Bangladesh	25 August	
	September 2017	
GoB reports that between 300,000 and 400,000 of undocumented Myanmar national crossed the border following the august attacks. This increases the official estimated number of displaced people in the Cox Bazar area to about 900,000, which is expected to increase to 1 million before the end of the year.	14 September	CSMT#1 - CSMT Declares L1. Decisions: An allocation of USD 100,000 for coordination, assessment and planning An allocation of USD 200,000 to initiate early recovery and shelter activities (this allocation is contingent to the government accepting UNDP as an additional agency to operate in Cox Bazaar) The deployment of a team Leader for the Early recovery assessment in Cox's Bazar – expected initial duration of 3 months The deployment of a team Leader for the conflict sensitive assessment and analysis in Cox's Bazar – expected initial duration of 3 months
UN calls for about USD 18 millions for the next 90 days	date?	
	18 September	Allocation of TRAC funds for the Rohingya response (USD 100,000)
	date?	CO has established an internal working group for the crisis
	October 2017	
Cumulative new arrivals in Bangladesh 507,000 people (195,000 in camps, 92,000 with host communities, 220,000 in spontaneous settlements); need for emergency shelter for 300,000 people	3 October	CB#1 (joint Myanmar Bangladesh). Key decisions: L2 crisis declared; deployment of light SURGE Planning Team; RD meeting in BKK for guidance to COs; prepare donor's coordination meeting; support CO fundraising; prepare UNDP-UNHCR meeting; gender; allocation of USD 500,000 for programme activities and increase of previous allocation by USD 100,000
Humanitarian Response Plan (Sept 2017 to Feb 2018); UNDP is not part of the Plan	date?	
	12 October	RD meeting in BKK

	22 October	Deployment Social Risk Assessment Team Leader/Conflict Analyses Expert/ Risk Analysis Assessment Team Leader (Robert Templer)
	22 October	Deployment Conflict Analyses Expert/ Social Risk Assessment Expert (Lawrence Lachmansingh)
	22 October	SURGE-funded extension of contract of national Individual Consultant working in existing Cox's Bazar environmental project (Satyajit Roy) to a) initially support assessment teams; b) support establishment and resource mobilization for sub-office environmental programmes. Position absorbed in sub-office programme as of December 2018.
Donors Pledging Conference in Geneva	23 October	
	24 October	CMST2
	date?	UNDP assessments start (Social, economic and environmental assessments)
	29 Oct-3 Nov	SURGE Planning Mission: Bettina from Crisis Bureau (lead), Henny (BPPS), Mohammad and Ram Iyer (COSQA, RBAP).
	31 October	CMST3 (on Myanmar only)
	November 2017	
	Date?	UNDP established presence in CxB (later will establish a Sub-Office in Cox's Bazar)
UNDP included in the Protection Working Group	Date?	
	7 November	Additional TRAC Funds allocated to Rohingya Crisis after CB declares it an L2 (USD 100,000)
Strategic Executive Group (SEG) meeting - chaired by RC and cochaired by IOM and UNHCR	15 November	
	17 November	CB#3: SURGE Plan generally endorsed; Results and Resource Frameworks to be finetuned; CO to develop a Recovery Programme; CMST to monitor progress of the Surge plan implementation
Inter-Sector Coordination Group (ISCG) meeting in CxB	dates?	
	25 November	End of Deployment Social Risk Assessment Team Leader/Conflict Analyses Expert/ Risk Analysis Assessment Team Leader (Robert Templer)
	December 2017	
	1 December	Deployment International Programme Manager/ Recovery and Resilience Programme Manager / Coordinator (Rhonda Gossen)
	3 December	UNDP Early Recovery Facility staff sent on three-day mission to Cox's Bazar for follow-up of Host Community Assessment consultant and participation in Site Management Sector meeting on disaster risk management
	10 December	Deployment International Consultant -Senior Waste Management Advisor (Faisal Ridwan)
Inter-Sector Coordination Group (ISCG) meeting in CxB	Date?	

	16 December	End of deployment Conflict Analyses Expert/ Social Risk Assessment Expert (Lawrence Lachmansingh)
	22 December	End of deployment Environmental Safeguard Specialist/ Environmental Impact Assessment Team Leader (Alexandre Chaikine)
	January 2018	
	2 January	Deployment Procurement Specialist (Samer Abu Hawilih)
	4 January	Deployment Recovery Advisor (Mir Ali Asgar)
	8 January	Deployment Admin & Logistic Services Consultant (Sha Alam)
	9 January	Deployment to the country of Regional Coordinator / Head of Sub Office, Cox Bazar (Jan-Jilles Van der Hoeven) – initially engaged with RCO
	9 January	Deployment of TRAC-funded Early Recovery Facility individual consultant (Cathrine Haarsaker) to Cox's Bazar for one week mission to develop disaster risk management proposal for submission to ECHO. Mission was later extended up to 14 August 2018 with co-funding from UNHCR and ECHO. Position has been absorbed in sub-office programming.
	10 January	Deployment International Programme Support Manager/ Governance Programme Manager/Coordinator (Sumeeta Banerji)
	15 January	Deployment International Programme Manager/ UN Coordination Specialist (Host Communities Support) (Maurice Dewulf)
	15 January	UNDP requested by ISCG to draft Terms of Reference for Disaster Risk Reduction Working Group.
	22 January	UNDP requested by ISCG to act as technical advisor to Emergency Preparedness and Response Task Force.
	27 January	Deployment International Programme Support Manager (Ewelina Pusz)
	February 2018	
	3 February	End of deployment Early Recovery Specialist/ Early Recovery Assessment Team Leader (Paul Bonard)
	7 February	CMST4
UNOCT mission in Dhaka	12-15 Feb	
	18 February	Deployment Information Management Officer (Ameen Hashmi)
	27 February	Additional TRAC Funds allocated to Rohingya Crisis (USD 25,000) to establish UNDP presence in Cox's Bazar
	March 2018	
	2 March	Deployment Waste Management Trainee (Inger Nygren)
1,070,000 Rohingya registered to date in Bangladesh	7 March	CB#4: SURGE period extended to 6 months including SURGE Plan; BGD CO requests additional USD 500,000 and agrees to share progress of response, recovery strategy document and JRP proposals

	11 March	Deployment Admin & Logistic Services Consultant (Nurul Alam)
Launch of the Joint Response Plan for the Rohingya Refugee Crisis (USD 920million)	16 March	
	16 March	End of deployment International Programme Manager/ Recovery and Resilience Programme Manager / Coordinator (Rhonda Gossen)
	22-24 March	Haoliang Xu, RBAP Regional Director visits Bangladesh
	Apr 2018	
	2 April	Deployment Host Community Support Specialist (Rhonda Gossen)
	7 April	End of deployment Regional Coordinator / Head of Sub Office (Jan-Jilles Van der Hoeven)
	7 April	Deployment Early Warning Dissemination and Training Specialist (Chris Piper)
	8 April	End of deployment International Programme Support Manager/ Governance Programme Manager/Coordinator (Sumeeta Banerji)
	14 April	End of deployment International Programme Manager/ UN Coordination Specialist (Host Communities Support) (Maurice Dewulf)
	14 April	Deployment Communications Specialist (Stacey Winston)
	15 April	Deployment Regional Coordinator / Head of Sub-Office, (Trond Husby)
Open Society Foundation visit to CXB	26 April	End of deployment Waste Management Trainee (Inger Nygren)
UN Security Council visit to CXB	27-28 April	
	May 2018	
Inception meeting on impact assesment (DC Office)	7 May	UNDP and partners impact assessment
	11 May	End of deployment International Consultant -Senior Waste Management Advisor (Faisal Ridwan)
Host Community Consultation: ISCG-CSO-NGO Forum, 12 May 2018	12 May	
	21 May	Deployment Livelihoods Specialist / Livelihoods-Emergency Enterprise Development Specialist (Jess Garana)
	31 May	Deployment Recovery Advisor (Mir Ali Asgar)
	June 2018	
	6 June	CMST5
USAID field visit CXB	7 June	End of deployment Admin & Logistic Services Consultant (Sha Alam)
JRP mid Term review	Date?	

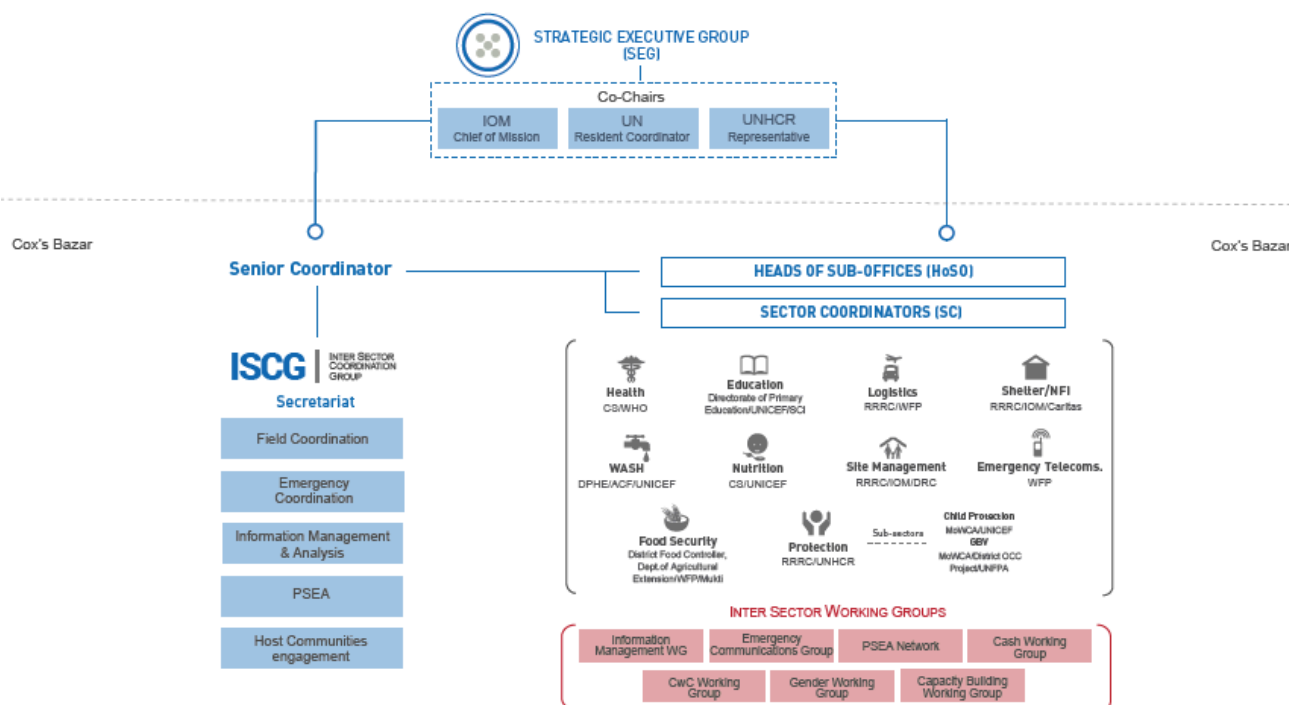
	10 June	End of Deployment Admin & Logistic Services Consultant (Nurul Alam)
	24 June	Deployment Disaster Risk Reduction Specialist (Sydney Tupper) UNDER COMPLETION 23 July 2019
	26-28 June	Sanny Jegillos, Senior DRR Advisor visit to BGD
	30 June	End of deployment Host Community Support Specialist (Rhonda Gossen)
	July 2018	
	6 July	End of deployment Early Warning Dissemination and Training Specialist (Chris Piper)
	August 2018	
	6 August	End of deployment Communications Specialist (Stacey Winston)
	13 August	End of deployment Information Management Officer (Ameen Hashmi)
	18 August	End of Deployment Procurement Specialist (Samer Abu Hawilih)
	20 August	End of deployment Livelihoods Specialist/ Livelihoods-Emergency Enterprise Development Specialist, Cox's Bazar (Jess Garana)
	September 2018	
	11 September	CMST; de escalation of L2 (closure)
	October 2018	
	Date?	UNDP Commissioned impact assessment in host communities
	8-10 Oct	RBAP Deputy Regional Director, visits Bangladesh following RBAP's Management Meeting (8-10 Oct) as part of a joint mission with UNHCR and IOM,
	27 October	End of deployment Regional Coordinator / Head of Sub-Office, Cox's Bazar (Trond Husby)
	Nov 2018	
	10 November	End of Deployment SURGE Waste Management Specialist, Cox's Bazar (6 months)
	12 November	End of deployment International Programme Support Manager (Ewelina Pusz)
	26 November	End of Deployment SURGE Governance Programme Manager/Coordinator, Dhaka(3 months) Renamed: International Programme Support Manager

g. Annex VII – Coordination

Dhaka

Dhaka

HUMANITARIAN STAKEHOLDERS



h. Annex VIII – Overview of projects

The Community Recovery and Resilience Programme (C2RP) is funded from UNDP's Global Rule of Law Programme and Conflict Prevention Windows. This funding was a direct result of the joint mission between UNDP, UNHCR and UN Women that took place in January 2018. The C2RP project includes the following components: 1) Formal and informal mechanisms for dispute resolution to increase access to justice and mitigate risks of conflict and violence; 2) Community security and people-oriented policing, including services for individuals at-risk of gender-based violence; and 3) Support to National Human Rights Commission of Bangladesh to be fully functional in Cox's Bazar. The project started implementation in Cox's Bazar in August 2018.

The "Support to community stabilization and resilience" project, funded by Germany and implemented in collaboration with UN Women, has been approved in August 2018 and has just started implementation in October 2018. It has three main outputs: Community security and gender responsive policing; gender-based violence (GBV) services provided to individuals at risk of GBV; social cohesion and participatory planning.

In addition to the above, three programmatic areas are notable: solid waste management, disaster risk management, and conflict prevention:

UNDP had identified a possible niche in solid waste management (SWM) in one of its first interventions: the cash for work / livelihoods project implemented by Action Aid Bangladesh. The cash for work pilot at the time invested both on road repair and rehabilitation, and on solid waste management. This was recognized as an important gap in the response (the amount of waste generated monthly as a consequence of the presence of so many people is massive, and the local systems were unable to respond). The SWM project has three main components: build government capacities, promote SWM livelihoods, and build SWM infrastructure (landfill). It is funded by Sweden and started in October 2018, around one year after the beginning of the influx.

The recognized expertise UNDP has in disaster risk management in the country has been instrumental in positioning it for DRM activities also in the context of the Rohingya response.

UNDP's DRM programme in CXB has six main components:

- Local government DRM capacity enhancement
- Risk analysis and assessment
- CBDRM
- DRR technical support to the humanitarian community
- Capacity Development for first response
- Disaster Risk informed Planning Capacities

Within this programme, ECHO funds a consortium led by IOM and comprising also UNDP and German Red Cross to work with the local government to enhance their capacity for extreme weather and disaster management. Funding has been available since the end of 2017, however reported delays on the part of the consortium lead have caused project implementation to be significantly postponed. DRM projects have been designed in phases so that subsequent funding can build upon achievement of previous phases.

Finally, UNDP has identified a niche in conflict analysis. According to some stakeholders, the response was initially conflict-blind and the social risk analysis conducted by UNDP, particularly on the political economy of the crisis and the refugee response was instrumental in ensuring more conflict-sensitive programming. This is a very useful input that UNDP contributed to the response community, and it should continue to build on this niche. It is clear after the "social risk assessment incident that some issues need to be managed very carefully, but it does not mean that they should be avoided, on the contrary. With this initiative UNDP can provide useful and innovative inputs to the overall response and increase its quality. At the moment it has one project funded by the Netherlands and for which more funding is in pipeline from Norway: Partnership for a Tolerant, Inclusive Bangladesh." Project implementation started in Cox's Bazar in October 2018.

i. Annex IX – Bibliography

- AAVV, *JRP For Rohingya Humanitarian Crisis - Final For Distribution*, 2018
- AAVV, *JRP For Rohingya: Mid Term Review*, 2018
- AAVV, *Myanmar – Bangladesh Crisis Board*, 2018
- AAVV, *Rohingya Refugee Crisis Response Plan: Monitoring Report*, 2017

AAVV, *Strengthening National And Local System In Responding To The Influx To Bangladesh From Myanmar: UNDP, UNHCR, UN WOMEN Joint Mission Report*, 2018

AAVV, *UNDP Early Recovery Assessment: annex 1- 4*, 2017

HUMANITARIAN COUNTRY TEAM, *Humanitarian Response Plan Rohingya Refugee Crisis: Final Report*, 2018

HUMANITARIAN COUNTRY TEAM, *Humanitarian Response Plan- Draft Version*, 2017

IOM, *Strengthening extreme weather and disaster preparedness to enhance the resilience of host and Rohingya communities in Cox's Bazar, Banglades*, 2018

ISCG, *Bangladesh: Rohingya Refugee Response Coordination Mechanism*, 2018

ISCG, *JRP 2018 Funding Update - Sector Priority Activities*, 2018

ISCG, *JRP Mid-Term Review - Host Community Workshop Information Review, Gap Analysis And Prioritization Exercise Workshop Report*, 2018

ISCG, *Rohingya Crisis Response Update*, 2017

ISCG, *Rohingya Refugee Emergency Preparedness and Response*, 2018

ISCG, *Rohingya Refugee Emergency Preparedness and Response: ppt*, 2018

ISCG, *Situation Report Data Summary Rohingya Refugee Crisis*, 2018

ISCG, *Support to Bangladesh Host Communities in the Rohingya Refugee Response*, 2018

MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS, *No objection to inclusion of 04 UN Agencies*, 2017

PRI, *The Rohingya Refugee Crisis and the Host Community: An Assessment of Socio-economic Impact, Public Service Delivery and Social Safety Nets*, 2018

RIZVI SUMBUL, *The Rohingya Influx: One-Year-On*

SEG, *Rohingya Refugee Response: Lessons Learned Workshop*, 2018

UN, *Resident Coordinator Key Messages On Rohingya Crisis*, 2017

UNDP BANGLADESH, *Conflict Analyses Expert*, 2017

UNDP BANGLADESH, *Early Recovery Specialist*, 2017

UNDP BANGLADESH, *Environmental Impact Of Rohingya Influx: Report*, 2018

UNDP BANGLADESH, *Livelihoods Specialist Consultancy Vacancy*

UNDP BANGLADESH, *ToR: Host Community Support Specialist*, 2018

UNDP BANGLADESH, *ToR: Information Management Officer (IMO)*

UNDP BANGLADESH, *ToR: International Programme Manager*

UNDP BANGLADESH, *ToR: International Programme Support Manager*

UNDP CXB, *Weekly Updates from February to September 2018*

UNDP, *Automated Rain-Water Gauges In Cox's Bazar*, 2018

UNDP, *Bangladesh Surge Plan Implementation Status (monthly updates)*

UNDP, *CB meeting: Summary of discussion - Bangladesh and Myanmar*, 17 November 2017

UNDP, *CB meeting: Summary of discussion - Bangladesh and Myanmar*, 20 October 2017

UNDP, *CB meeting: Summary of discussion - Bangladesh and Myanmar*, 3 October 2017

UNDP, *CB meeting: Summary of discussion - Bangladesh and Myanmar*, 7 March 2018

UNDP, *Clearance Certification: Project Document or Project/Budget/AWP for 2018*, 2018

UNDP, *CMST meeting: BGD Rohingya Crisis - Meeting Notes*, 7 February 2018

UNDP, *CMST meeting: Draft Summary of discussion - Bangladesh*, 11 September 2018

UNDP, *CMST meeting: Draft Summary of discussion - Rohingya*, 24 October 2017

UNDP, *CMST meeting: Summary of discussion – Bangladesh and Myanmar*, 14 September 2017

UNDP, *CMST meeting: Summary of discussion – Rakhine (Myanmar)*, 30 October 2017

UNDP, *CMST meeting: Summary of discussion- Bangladesh*, 6 June 2018

UNDP, *Crisis Board – ToR*, 2018

UNDP, *Crisis Board Secretariat – ToR*, 2018

UNDP, *Crisis Management Support Team – ToR*, 2018

UNDP, *Crisis Response Criteria Definitions*, 2018

UNDP, *Crisis Response Exigency Memo*, 2017

UNDP, *Disaster Risk Management In Cox's Bazar District (Phase 2)*

UNDP, *Disaster Risk Management In Cox's Bazar: Response to Rohingya Crisis (Phase 1)*
 UNDP, *Disaster Risk Reduction Specialist-Rohingya Response-ToR*
 UNDP, *District Community Cohesion Roadmap Design And Implementation*
 UNDP, *Draft Early Warning Dissemination and Training Specialist -ToR*
 UNDP, *DRR Technical Advisory Unit In Cox's Bazar, 2018*
 UNDP, *Emergency Funding - Rohingya Crisis BGD, 2018*
 UNDP, *Emergency Hosting*
 UNDP, *Expanded Social Safety Net*
 UNDP, *Fast Track Identification Of Accelerated Growth Opportunities In Cox's Bazar*
 UNDP, *First Responder Profiles, 2018*
 UNDP, *Head of Sub-office Letter, 2018*
 UNDP, *Letter to CO Bangladesh HCSS, 2018*
 UNDP, *Localization Of The Crisis Response And Civil Society Capacity Strengthening*
 UNDP, *Organization And Capacity Strengthening Support Public Service And Public Good Providers*
 UNDP, *Quick Impact Confidence Building And Deconflicting Initiative*
 UNDP, *Response to Rakhine Crisis, 2017*
 UNDP, *Response To Rohingya Crisis: Host Community Recovery And Resilience Programme (Phase 1)*
 UNDP, *Response To Rohingya Crisis: Host Community Recovery And Resilience Programme (Phase 2)*
 UNDP, *Rohingya Crisis Host Community Recovery and Resilience Program Strengthening Local Governance Processes For Service Delivery: Community Engagement And Community Infrastructure In Ukhiya And Teknaf*
 UNDP, *Rule Of Law, Community Security & Human Rights: Response To The Rohingya Crisis (Phase 1)*
 UNDP, *Rule Of Law, Community Security & Human Rights: Response To The Rohingya Crisis (Phase 2)*
 UNDP, *Senior Response Coordinator – ToR, 2018*
 UNDP, *Standard Operating Procedure For Immediate Crisis Response, 2018*
 UNDP, *Support Displacement Crisis BGD, 2017*
 UNDP, *Support To The Implementation Of Revised Cox's Bazar District Development Plan*
 UNDP, *SURGE Communication Advisor*
 UNDP, *SURGE for Bangladesh Rohingya Refugee Response: ToR For Waste Management Specialist*
 UNDP, *SURGE for Bangladesh Rohingya Refugee Response: ToR Recovery and Resilience Specialist*
 UNDP, *SURGE for Bangladesh Rohingya Refugee Response: ToR Regional Coordinator-Head of Sub Office CXB*
 UNDP, *SURGE Procurement Specialist*
 UNDP, *Team Leader Environmental Impact Assessment of Rohingya Refugee influx into Bangladesh-ToR*
 UNDP, *UNDP and UNHCR Install Rain Gauges In Landslide-Prone Areas Of The Rohingya Refugee Sites To Provide Real-Time Information During The Monsoon Season: Press Release, 2018*
 UNDP, *UNDP Response To The Rohingya Crisis And Its Impact On Cox's Bazar District And Host Communities Strategy Note 2018-2020, 2018*
 UNDP, *UNDP Response to the Rohingya Crisis and its impact on Cox's Bazar District and Host Communities Strategy Note, 2018*
 UNDP, *UNDP Support To Government Disaster Management In Cox's Bazar, 2018*
 UNDP, *UNDP SURGE for Bangladesh: ToR – UN Coordination Specialist (Host Community Support)*
 UNDP, *UNDP SURGE Plan Response to the Rohingya Refugee Crisis in Bangladesh, 2018*
 UNDP, *Waste Management Cox's Bazar District (Phase 1- pilot)*
 UNDP, *Waste Management Cox's Bazar District (Phase 2)*
 UNDP/UNWOMEN, *Social Impact Assessment Of The Rohingya Refugee Crisis Into Bangladesh Key Findings And Recommendations, 2017*
 WINSTON STACEY, *UNDP Communications Strategy, 2018*